



Moderator Guide

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Change log

2.92: 29 July 2025: Added more details and example in image moderation section

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Overview

To ensure the consistency and quality of the information in iOverlander, all Places must be reviewed before permanent inclusion in the database. To achieve this goal, iOverlander has developed a system of Tasks which are assigned to Moderators (that's you!) for assessment. Actions by Users (all the Overlanders out there!) generate the Tasks. There are five different types of Tasks:

1. New Place Approvals
2. Eliminate Duplicates
3. Place Corrections
4. Place Issues
5. Flagged Checkins

The greatest number of Tasks we receive are New Place Approvals and this is the type of Task that you will be working on most frequently. Therefore, the Moderator Guide will concentrate heavily on this Task type.

Before we jump into explaining the technicalities of how our Task system works, we need to explain our Criteria and Guidance for iOverlander Places (Part 1) and our General Rules (Part 2). These two parts of our Moderator Guide will give you a foundation which governs all your decisions as a Moderator.

After you feel you have a grasp of our Criteria and Rules, we'll introduce you to the iOverlander Task system. We'll first explain some very basic procedures, such as how to log in, and how to assign Tasks (Part 3). Then in Parts 4 through 8, we'll walk you through completing each Task type.

Once you have read through the **first four parts** of this Moderator Guide, connect with your Coach who will send you a series of "quizzes" specifically designed to help you remember the information in the first two parts. These are open book quizzes and you can refer to this Guide at any time! Our goal is to help you learn *where* to locate the answers, not to force memorization of every piece of information.

You will start off with short assignments and you will probably have many questions. Don't be afraid to confer with your Coach, even if the questions seem trivial to you. The more Tasks you do, the faster you will be able to complete them. You'll become more and more familiar with the Criteria and Rules and you will also learn the many shortcuts built into our system.

Moderating is challenging and fun. We hope the 'challenging' aspect will keep your interest and inspire your continued valuable contribution to iOverlander.

Thank you!

The iOverlander Team

Part 1: Criteria and Guidance for iOverlander Places

A 'Place' in the iOverlander database is a unique geographic location with a description of resources for Overlanders. Thousands of Users around the world contribute information about Places. To ensure that all Places in our database are relevant and support our mission, we've created the following Criteria, which are also published on the iOverlander website for Users to view.

Part 1 of the Moderator Guide describes these Criteria and adds additional guidance for Moderators, specifically to help understand common situations found while moderating.

Contents

1. iOverlander Mission and Definition
2. General Criteria
3. General Criteria Examples
4. Category-Specific Criteria and Guidance for Places
5. Links and Moderator Training Tools

iOverlander Mission and Definition

Mission

iOverlander's mission is to support overland exploration of the world, while respecting local cultures, people and environments.

Definition

iOverlander is a tool, by and for Overlanders, which enables its Users to submit, amend and find information and opinions, primarily about places that are essential for the act of overlanding, and secondarily about non-essential places that are of interest to a significant group of Overlanders.

General Criteria

This section describes the General Criteria which must be met by every Place in the iOverlander database. Although a Place may meet these Criteria, this does not guarantee that it will be accepted. Category-Specific Criteria, described below, must also be met.

To accomplish our mission, we set forth the following General Criteria:

We ensure that all Places in the iOverlander database:

1. Are of interest to the majority of at least one type of Overlander.
Types of Overlanders include:
 - Car travelers
 - Big rig travelers
 - Motorcycle travelers
 - Bicycle travelers
 - Travelers with pets
 - Travelers with children
 - Travelers working remotely
2. Presently exist and remain valid for Overlanders in the near future.
3. Do not violate laws or wishes of local people or damage the environment.
4. Contain relevant, quality and respectful information.
5. Must be physically visited by the Place contributor. If the service is not used (i.e. they did not stay the night), it must be clear that the place was thoroughly investigated.
6. Are not given preferential treatment for iOverlander's financial gain.
7. Must not discriminate against individuals based on inherent characteristics like race, gender, or nationality, unless the purpose is to support a marginalized minority group.

General Criteria Examples

Here are a few examples to help you better understand and interpret the above General Criteria:

1. All Places must be of interest to the majority of at least one type of Overlander.

- Example 1: Public transport is generally not of interest to Overlanders: it should be rejected.
- Example 2: Veterinary clinics are of interest to Overlanders with pets and should be accepted.
- Example 3: Places that sell goods and services that are not normally used by at least one type of Overlander such as beauty salons, massage parlors, lawyers, stores that sell appliances, craft supplies, furniture, electronics, household items, etc, should all be rejected. Although these Places may be of interest to a few Overlanders, they are not of interest to the majority of any one type of Overlander.

2. All Places must presently exist and must remain valid for Overlanders in the near future (be available for 4 weeks or more).

- Example 1: Temporary roadblocks should be rejected.
- Example 2: If a campsite is only available because of a special relationship with an owner, the Place should be rejected. For example, if a traveler met an owner in town and was invited to stay overnight, as a one-time invitation, the Place should be rejected.

3. All Places must not violate laws or wishes of local people or damage the environment.

- Example 1: Wild camps in national parks that prohibit wild camping should be rejected.
- Example 2: Wild camps that clearly disturb local people or damage the environment should be rejected.
- Example 3: Places which promote 'sneaking' into parks or tourist attractions to avoid entry fees should be rejected.
- Example 4: Checkpoints which describe how to hide contraband such as weapons, animals or illegal drugs should be rejected.

4. All Places must contain relevant and good quality information.

The assessment of 'good quality' information can be very subjective. Please consider the category and country of the Place. For Places that are essential to overlanding (eg campgrounds, gas stations in remote areas, vehicle shipping locations, etc) the description may not require a lot of detail to be considered 'good quality'.

- Example 1: A gas station with a review that says "Only petrol for 400kms" should be accepted, even though the description is short. This Place is clearly important, and the description contains relevant information.
- Example 2: A tourist attraction that only says "Nice view" should be rejected. This description does not contain good quality information, and this is not an important Place to Overlanders.

5. All Places must be physically visited by the Place contributor. If the service is not used (i.e. they did not stay the night), it must be clear that the place was thoroughly investigated.

- Example 1: An informal campsite with the description "You might be able to stay the night here, we didn't ask but it looked nice driving by", should be rejected. This place was clearly not investigated, the User doesn't even know if you can stay the night!
- Example 2: A petrol station in a remote area with the description, "They sell diesel and petrol, but the cost was ridiculous, and we had enough to get back to town so we didn't fill up" should be accepted. Even though they didn't use the services, they did investigate what was available and the costs.

6. Are not given preferential treatment for iOverlander's financial gain.

Example 1: iOverlander does not allow any paid promotions or paid spots from any category of

place.

7. **Must not discriminate against individuals based on inherent characteristics like race, gender, or nationality, unless the purpose is to support a marginalized minority group.**

Our goal is to support places that celebrate and protect underserved or underrepresented communities, such as LGBTQ+ individuals or racial minorities. We allow places to exclude certain people, but only when necessary to foster a safe space for these groups.

- Example 1: A German country club in Peru that only allows German passport holders should be rejected as it is discriminating against other nationalities and is not a marginalized group.
- Example 2: A gay men's club in California that only admits men, is technically discriminating against other genders, but it is doing so to protect a marginalized group, and should be accepted.

Category-Specific Criteria and Guidance

Additional criteria which must be met, based on the category of the Place under review.

Established Campground: Campgrounds that advertise camping, regardless of amenities provided.

No additional criteria.

Moderator guidance:

- Established campgrounds include everything from RV parks with every imaginable amenity to designated areas in a national park without any facilities. Usually, established campgrounds have facilities specifically designed for campers, but not always. The minimum to be expected is that camping is permissible and safe.

Informal Campsite: An unadvertised camp spot associated with another business or institution (restaurant, gas station, etc).

Additional criteria:

- As per the General Criteria above, camping must be permitted. If the campsite is private property, or locals do not allow camping, or camping damages the environment, or 'No Camping' signs are posted, the Place must be rejected.

Moderator guidance:

- Informal campgrounds are Places that do not advertise camping, but will allow it. They are usually associated with another business (such as hotel, restaurant, museum, etc). Facilities may include security guarding, toilets, showers, wifi and electricity.

- If the campsite is remote or not attached to any other facilities, the category should be reassigned to Wild Camping. For example, parking in a street in a town is a 'wild camp'.

Wild Camping: A camping spot not linked to a business or institution regardless of amenities or formal permissions.

Additional criteria:

- As per the General Criteria, camping must be permitted. If the Place is private property, locals do not permit camping, camping damages the environment, or 'No Camping' signs are posted, the Place must be rejected.
- If the campsite is in an abandoned building, the User must state that permission has been explicitly given.
- If the User did not spend the night the place should be rejected, unless wild camps are extremely rare in the area.

Moderator guidance:

- Wild camps are camping spots not linked to another business or institution. They rarely have amenities, and don't cost money. Wild camps do not require permission of a nearby facility; permission is implied by the location.
- Reserves, Forests, Parks, BLM land or other large wilderness areas that allow camping, but do not have designated sites, are considered wild camps.
- "No camping" signs always mean "No overnight parking" as well. In iOverlander there is no difference between camping in your tent and sleeping in your van. Please reject these places, even if users claim that overnight parking is allowed despite "no camping" signs.
- Mentions of 'stealth camping' in a Place description are usually related to a traveler wishing to keep a low profile for privacy. However, read the description carefully to look for other phrases that indicate the camping place is illegal, such as: 'no camping' signs posted, camping in abandoned buildings without permission, hiding to avoid officials, or arriving late or early to avoid payment.

Hotel: Private accommodations.

Additional criteria:

- Hotels must typically be available without reservation. Apartment or home rentals that are ONLY available if pre-booked (such as on Airbnb) should be rejected.
- Long-term apartment rentals should be rejected.

Hostel: Accommodations for groups of people.

No additional criteria.

Fuel Station: A place to purchase vehicle fuel.

Additional criteria:

- Fuel stations in towns where many other stations are available should be rejected. If the Moderator cannot determine this availability, the Place should be accepted by default. Exceptions to this requirement are:
 - High quality fuel stations in countries where quality is an issue (eg Tajikistan or Russia) should be accepted.
 - Fuel stations in countries where purchase by a foreigner is difficult (eg Bolivia) should be accepted.
 - Fuel stations with descriptions of specific problems (eg a fuel station that filled the tank with fuel from a rusty water-covered barrel, or a traveler was ripped off, or had to wait for hours for some reason) should be accepted.
 - Fuel stations with specific extra amenities that are helpful to overlanders, such as cheaper fuel, ULSD Diesel , Air, etc

Moderator guidance:

- Fuel stations that permit camping should be assigned to the Informal Camping category.

Propane: A place to fill propane tanks.

Additional criteria:

- Local shops that only swap bottles should be rejected.
- Places that refill bottles or fixed tanks should be accepted.

Mechanic and Parts: A mechanic or a parts store.

Additional criteria:

- Companies that focus solely on selling or renting vehicles should be rejected.

Water: A place to obtain potable water.

Additional criteria:

- Water that is only accessible from a special tool or key should be rejected, these are not public taps and should be rejected.
- Water sources accessed through campgrounds or hotels should be rejected.
- Natural sources of water (rivers, lakes, etc) should be rejected. unless user states there is no water as the place is very remote.

Short-term parking: Daytime parking for overlander vehicles

Additional criteria:

- Must be daytime or overnight parking where the owner **DOES NOT** sleep in the vehicle.

Eco-friendly: Places to help eco-friendly overlanders, like recycling centers, bio-fuel stations, etc.

Additional criteria:

- All items must be stand-alone facilities, or independently available of other services (recycling bins in a restaurant should be rejected).
- Places to obtain recycled vegetable oil or bio-fuel should be accepted. Other types of fuel, such as low sulfur diesel, should be reassigned to the fuel station category.
- Other eco-friendly points should be accepted, if they are of interest to overlanders and do not fit in another category.

Moderator guidance:

- Eco-camps should be reassigned to accommodation categories.
- Eco-training courses should be reassigned to the Tourist Attraction category.

Sanitation Dump Station: A place to empty a black water tank.

Additional criteria:

- A sanitation dump station that is only accessible to registered campers should not be listed in this category. It should rather be an amenity of the campground.

Restaurant: Exceptionally good or bad restaurants (food, value, price, location, etc).

Additional criteria:

- The description of the restaurant must be detailed and good quality.
- The restaurant itself must be of exceptionally good or bad quality (by quality we mean either the food, the prices, or the location). However, restaurants of mediocre quality are allowed if they are in a very remote area.
- The above two criteria should be *strictly* enforced if there are other restaurants in iOverlander within 4km.

Moderator guidance:

- The Restaurant category exists to provide a resource for when Overlanders really need it, just like camping. Don't be afraid to reject low quality restaurant entries. They are likely to occur more often in this category than anywhere else.
- The location of the restaurant determines how strictly to apply the criteria. It's good practice to view the restaurant pin with all the other pins surrounding it. Before you make a decision, ask yourself:
 - Is the restaurant pin swimming in a sea of other restaurant pins? If so, it's ok to accept the restaurant, but make sure the description and the restaurant are high quality.
 - Is the restaurant all by its lonesome on a highway? This restaurant could be helpful to cyclists, and therefore a mediocre restaurant with a mediocre description should be accepted.
- If you are struggling to determine if the restaurant description is good quality, consider whether it contains the following:
 - More than 100 characters.

- Details on price. Descriptions such as 'cheap'/'expensive'/'average' are fine: specific prices are not necessary.
- The type of cuisine offered (mexican, pizza, cocktails, etc).
- Amenities that are important to Overlanders (wifi, parking, etc), if *applicable*.
- The reason the restaurant is good quality (good price, good location, good food) and what specifically makes it so good. (eg not just "the best pizza", but what specifically makes the pizza so good.)

The above five items are NOT required for acceptance, but they may be helpful to gauge the quality of the description. Again, how strictly you apply the "quality description" criteria depends on the location of the restaurant.

- A restaurant description does not need to be lengthy to be considered good quality. Here are a few examples:
 - Reject a Place if the description says:
 - 'Great cheap meals.'
 - 'The lomo was good.'
 - 'Good place out of the hot sun, decent local food'. (Where the restaurant is in the middle of a city with other options nearby.)
 - Accept a Place if the description says:
 - 'Quiet café on the hillside with fresh baked pastries and excellent but expensive coffee. Free wifi.'
 - 'Great tacos with homemade pulled-pork. Take-a-way only and no place to sit, closed on weekends'
 - 'Good place out of the hot sun, decent local food'. (Where the restaurant is in the middle of nowhere.)

Tourist Attraction: Attractions, tour guides and tourist information centers.

Additional criteria:

- The description must provide detailed helpful information. Places with short or vague descriptions should be rejected.
- The attraction must be significant: a description of a 'nice panorama' along the road or a 'pretty flower in the pavement' should be rejected.

Moderator guidance:

- Tourist information centers, playgrounds, day recreation areas, swimming pools, access points to a tourist attraction (ie an entry gate or start of a trail) all belong in this category.

Shopping: Locations for purchasing goods related to overlanding (groceries, gear, etc)

Additional criteria:

- Shopping Places should be accepted if they are of interest to the majority of one type of Overlander. For example:
 - High quality grocery stores and food stores should be accepted.
 - A low-quality grocery store with an unhelpful (or vague) description, should be rejected, unless noted it is in a very remote area.
 - Souvenir stands should be rejected as most Overlanders would not find them useful.

- Local handmade artisan goods or markets should be accepted as most Overlanders would find such Places of interest.
- If the type of store is common in the area (eg panderias in Mexico), the User must state why this Place is of exceptional quality. This is not required if the store is a rarity in the area (such as liquor stores in the UAE).

Moderator guidance:

- The following shopping places should be reassigned to their related category:
 - Car parts go in Mechanic
 - Pharmacies go in Medical
 - SIM cards go in Wifi
 - Pet goods go in Pet Services

Financial: An ATM, bank or currency exchange, relevant to overlanders.

Additional criteria:

- Banks or ATMs must be a rarity in the area, or have exceptionally favorable withdrawal fees, amounts, or currencies.
- Money exchanges must be a rarity in the area, or in a country where currency exchange is complicated.
- Must not be illegal, unless "black market" trading is *common practice* in that country.

Wifi: A place to access the internet, either public, or private with good workspace

Additional criteria:

- The wifi itself must be a sufficient reason to visit the place. Wifi at campgrounds/hotels should be rejected.
- Use of wifi must be permitted by the business. Places that advertise "stealing" wifi should be rejected.
- Wifi must be decent quality given the location. A slow, intermittent connection in the Congo should be accepted, the same connection in downtown London should be rejected.
- Restaurants or cafes should be accepted, if they provide a good work environment (power outlets, quiet space, conference room, etc), or if the user states the restaurant is in a remote area (i.e. "only wifi in town".)
- Points related to cell signal are accepted if they include carrier information and are relevant to overlanders in remote areas (i.e. 4G Movistar signal from this point north, but no signal on the beach camping south of here.)

Medical: Recommended doctors, dentists or other medical professionals.

- Saunas, massage parlors, or any points related to obtaining illegal drugs should be rejected.

Pet Services: Veterinarians, supplies, or other services for pets.

No additional criteria.

Laundromat: Self-service or full-service laundry facilities.

No additional criteria.

Showers: Free or paid showers, that can be used independently of other services offered.

Additional criteria:

- Free and paid showers are accepted. However, showers accessed illegally or by evading payments, should be rejected.
- Travelers must be allowed to use the shower independently of other facilities.
- If the shower requires a related membership or facility fee, the fee must be stated in the description. The fee must be a reasonable expense for a single shower. Places requiring annual memberships should be rejected.

Moderator guidance:

A pool that offers a day rate that includes a shower should be accepted. A spa that requires you book an expensive spa session just for the shower, should be rejected. Hotels, massage parlors and most campgrounds require an expensive admittance to use a shower, and therefore would generally be rejected.

Customs and Immigration: Customs and immigration offices, etc.

No additional criteria.

Moderator guidance:

- This category is for customs and immigration stations usually encountered while crossing borders.
- Places in this category should usually include the direction of travel, the Users nationality, and the vehicle origin. If this information is not provided, the Place should still be accepted, but it is a good idea to email the User and ask for clarification. (See specific information for emailing Users in Part 2.)

Checkpoint: A permanent police, military or agricultural checkpoint.

Additional criteria:

- Temporary roadblocks or checkpoints should be rejected. They change too often to be of value to Overlanders.
- Checkpoints or tollbooths with very short, unhelpful descriptions should be rejected, unless checkpoints are rare in that region.

Moderator guidance:

- This category is for police or agriculture checkpoints encountered along the road. (Immigration and customs checkpoints must be reassigned to the Customs and Immigration category.)
- Tollbooths fall into this category, however, they should only be accepted if there is something unique about them (they only accept cash, are very rare in the area, etc.) Common everyday road tollbooths should be rejected, these places should be added to OSM.
- Checkpoints should include the direction of travel. If this information is not provided, the Place should still be accepted, but it is a good idea to email the User and ask for clarification. (See specific information for emailing Users in Part 2.)

Consulate/Embassy: A consulate or embassy.

No additional criteria.

Vehicle Insurance: A place where vehicle insurance can be purchased.

Additional criteria:

- Must issue insurance to vehicles with foreign registrations

Vehicle Shipping: Any office, port or place related to long-distance vehicle shipping, or difficult ferry crossings.

Additional criteria:

- The Place must either be related to long-distance vehicle shipping, or a ferry crossing with a long wait or difficult process. Short, easy crossings should be rejected. For example:
 - An easy 50m ferry crossing should be rejected.
 - International point of departures for vehicle shipping should be accepted.
 - A short ferry crossing with a wait of more than 2 hours, or involving a difficult process to purchase tickets, should be accepted.

Vehicle Storage: Locations that offer parking for overland vehicles for weeks or months.

No additional criteria.

Overnight Prohibited: Areas where camping or sleeping in a vehicle is not allowed.

Additional criteria:

- Must be a location overlanders are likely to camp in the future, such as: National Parks, beaches, tourist attractions OR cover a large area such as city ordinances that prohibit overnights.
- Not to be used for places where overlanders aren't likely to visit; ie. small private property, parking lots, very remote roads, etc

Moderator guidance:

This category is for LARGE AREAS where camping is illegal (e.g. an entire city, a national park, a big beach, another heavily touristed area). Please don't use it for small random parking spots, these places should simply be deleted.

Warning: Warnings about serious dangers to health, safety or property, or impassable roads that cause delays of two hours or more.

Additional criteria:

- This category is for serious dangers to personal health, safety or property.
- Warnings about muggings and thefts should be accepted.

- Warnings for major road problems should be accepted, if the road is NOT passable and causes a delay of two hours or more. The road only needs to be impassable by one type of vehicle. For example, a warning about a sandy road that is passable by 4x4's but not by sedans should be accepted.
- Warnings for big-rig travelers should be accepted, if the detour results in a 2-hour delay or more and the description includes the specific restriction (height of a low bridge, maximum weight, etc).
- Minor inconveniences and 'bumpy road' reports should be rejected, including steep hill climbs or long stretches with no amenities for cyclists.

Moderator guidance:

- Please make sure the Place name describes the specific warning. For example, if a User noticed suspicious activity, the name should **not** be "creeper in the bushes", it should be "potential theft area." Common warnings types are: potential theft area, armed robbery, dangerous area, road impassable, etc.
- Regarding road closures and washed out bridges, specifically check for the direction of travel and information on how long the situation is expected to remain. If the information is not provided, the Place should still be accepted, but it is a good idea to email the User and ask for clarification. (See specific information for emailing Users in Part 2)
- Any warnings related to checkpoints should go in the Checkpoint category, even if the warning is about a bribe.

Other: Another place of interest to Overlanders.

No additional criteria.

Moderator guidance:

- This category is for Places that do not fit any of the categories above but still meet the General Criteria requirements.
- Examples of Places to **reject** include:
 - Car rental locations
 - Car washes (unless a rarity and a necessity, such as leaving the Bolivian salt pans)
 - Highway rest stops and picnic areas. If the rest stop is a camping location it should be in the Informal Camping category.
 - Health and beauty parlors: spas, salons, massage parlors, saunas
 - Public toilets
 - Marketing agencies and spam
 - Cannabis dispensaries
 - Post offices & DHL offices (unless the description provides information that is relevant to Overlanders and that information is not likely to be found elsewhere).

Part 2: General Rules

In addition to the General and Category-Specific Criteria described in Part 1, we have some General Rules which apply to the moderation of all Places. In this Part we will explain these rules and clarify a few other important pieces of information you'll need for making the best decisions as a Moderator.

Contents

1. General Rules for Places
2. Images
3. Moderator Notes
4. Emailing Users
5. Closing Places vs 'Flag for Deletion'
6. Multiple Categories for one Place

General Rules for Places

The primary language of iOverlander is English.

We are hoping to support multiple languages in iOverlander in the future, however, for the time being we are limited to English. If the Place description is submitted in another language:

- Create an English translation with DeepL Translator or Google Translate and paste the English translation above the original language. **Do not delete the original language.**
- DeepL makes a browser extension that makes translating very quick. Download it here: <https://www.deepl.com/en/app/>
- You can divide the two languages with a line break and a series of dashes. For example: .

Out of season is super safe overnight, does not offer plugs and no place to dispose of waste

Fora de temporada é super seguro pernoite, não oferece tomadas e nem lugar pra descartar dejetos

- Make sure the translation makes sense; if not, improve the text.
- Do not translate Check-ins, only Place descriptions.

No Camping means No Overnight!

At iOverlander, any sign or law indicating “no camping” also means “no overnighting”. Sleeping in a vehicle is considered camping, even if you don’t put an awning and chairs out. Please treat all “No camping” signs the same as “No overnight parking” signs.

Promotional links or signatures must be removed.

We allow links that provide additional information, but not promotional links to a User’s personal blog or social media. Users are automatically given credit for Places and Check-ins added via their Blog name and link. Promotional links should be deleted.

Links that provide additional information, for example, links to extra details about a Place, detailed photos or maps, and special procedures for a complicated endeavor (eg border crossing, vehicle shipping), should remain in the Place description.

If a personal website is included in the Place description, we recommend that you review the User’s history (eg other Check-ins and Places the User has submitted to iOverlander). If the User has signed multiple Check-ins or Places, please email the User and ask the User to stop this practice. (See Part 3 for instructions on reviewing a Users’ History.)

Owners or managers must be clearly declared.

Owners or managers are welcome to create an account and add their Place, but they must make clear in their description and check-ins that they are posting as the owner. Owners cannot pretend to be travelers. Places submitted by owners must meet the same Criteria and Rules as all other Places.

Profanity is not allowed.

All profanity should be removed or replaced.

If used in a cheeky or descriptive way, the ‘bad’ word or words should be replaced with similar but non-offensive language. For example: "No Bull Shit fees here" could change to "No BS fees here". Or "F*cking awesome view" could change to "Freaking awesome view."

If the profanity is used in a malicious way, the offending section or the Check-in should be removed. Deleted text should be replaced with the following Moderator Note: "Comments removed because of inappropriate content."

If the profanity is malicious, please review the User’s history to determine if there are other instances of profanity. If other instances are found, email the User or seek advice from your Coach. (Instructions for reviewing User History are in Part 3.)

Discrimination, insults, hate speech and other nasty language is not allowed.

Any comments or posts that are vulgar, racist, political or discriminatory, or that blatantly attack or insult others should be removed. Deleted text should be replaced with the following Moderator Note:

"Comments removed because of inappropriate content."

Review the User's history and if more than one malicious post has been made and their contributions are not adding any value to iOverlander, contact your Coach so the User can be blocked.

Wifi Passwords are not allowed.

Remove all wifi passwords from Place descriptions. Wifi is intentionally password-protected because it is intended for use by customers only. If travelers require the wifi password, they must first become a paying customer. This is out of respect for business owners.

Please review the Users' history and look for other wifi passwords. If the User has added passwords to other Places, please send them an email. (Instructions for reviewing User History are in Part 3.)

Encouraging bribery and corruption is not tolerated.

Any comments that encourage or admit to paying bribes must be removed, regardless of the reason for the payment. This includes bribes to avoid a process (long line, lots of paperwork, etc), and explanations such as "It was getting late, so we paid a bribe to get to camp before dark".

Any comments that help Overlanders avoid paying bribes should be retained, as well as any information about *legitimate* fees.

Emoticons/Emojis should be removed.

Please remove special characters (such as emojis) from Place names and descriptions or convert them to plain text. Such characters cause problems in our other download formats (GPX and JSON files). It is ok to leave special characters in Check-ins.

Spelling and grammar usually does not need to be corrected.

There is no need to correct spelling or grammar unless the text is incomprehensible. Your goal should be to tidy the text so that it will be understandable to the majority of Users. We are not looking for perfect English.

Road-Related Points

Most road-related points should be made in OSM and NOT in iOverlander. They simply change too fast to be of value in our system. Here are some basic guidelines:

- Reject road condition reports unless the road is NOT passible and causing a 2 hour delay or reroute (these go in the Warning category, NOT in other). Reject all points that simply describe the surface of the road. (aka "bumpy road reports")

- Reject all points that describe new roads and new features (such as bridges and gates). If the user has added other points like this and or is likely to add more, please email the user and ask them to add the point to OSM (instructions on how to do this can be found here: <http://ioverlander.com/osm>)
- Turnoffs to other points should be in the category of the place being redirected to. For example a point that marks a turn off to a wild camp should be in the wild camp category.
- Points that provide information on tourist 4x4 routes should be in the Tourist attraction category.

Images

Because many Users do not have a fast or free internet connection, it is important to make sure that the images in our database are *relevant*. Please consider the following guidance when reviewing photos:

- Anything inappropriate or malicious should be deleted. (Nudity, sexually explicit, profanity, etc)
- Poor quality images where the subject cannot be seen should be deleted. (super low resolution, blurry, too dark, etc)
- Blog URLs or Instagram handles watermarked on photos are acceptable, unless it covers the entire image and does not contain other relevant information. QR codes linking to social media should be deleted.
- Duplicate or very similar photos should be deleted, when easy to detect.
- Screenshots of other mapping apps should be deleted unless they indicate a specific route.
- Screenshots of wifi speed tests should be kept, if the wifi is attached to the place (eg. establish campgrounds.) Wifi speeds for users personal connections, such as mobile data or starlink should be deleted.
- Photos of overland vehicles are fine, but only when used to illustrate the surrounding areas or space limitations. If the image ONLY shows the interior or exterior of the vehicle, it should be deleted. For example, these images do not show anything relevant and should be **removed**:



These images show the surrounding of the place in addition to the vehicle and should be **kept**:



- Photos where people are the main subject should usually be deleted. Except if the person is relevant to the Place, for example the owners of a Place, the mechanic, or an especially helpful tour guide. These photos are largely portraits of travelers and don't give any information about a Place, they should be **removed**:



These photos show relevant parts of the place in the background, or they show the person (doctor, mechanic) who is offering services at the place. They should be **kept**:



- Photos of pets follow the same rules as people. As long as the photo contains relevant information about the place, it is fine if it also includes a pet. These images are clearly just pet portraits and should be **removed**.



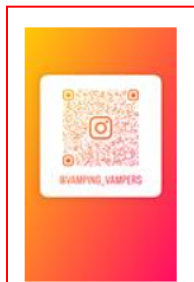
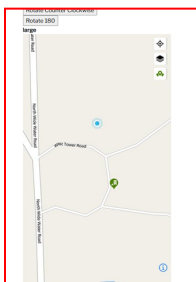
These photos include pets, but also show the place. They should be **kept**:



- These photos are very similar and one of each pair should be **removed**:



- Screenshots of google maps that do not give relevant information or QR codes that promote social media should be **removed**:



- Images of signs should be **investigated**, because they often indicate illegal camping.*





Moderator Notes

In certain circumstances, you must add a Moderator Note at the beginning of a Place description to help inform Users and other Moderators of certain situations. All moderator notes should begin with “MODERATOR NOTE:”.

Moderator Notes MUST always be added at the beginning of Place descriptions when a Place is rejected, regardless of the reason it is rejected. Please use our standard moderator notes, they are located in this [google sheet](#).

There are other situations where you might wish to add Moderator Notes to help make things clearer to Users, but these are at your discretion. **Remember that Moderator Notes should be polite and brief, please use our [standard replies](#)**. If a lengthy explanation or comment is required, it is preferable to send an email to the User. If you believe a new standard moderator note is needed, let your Coach know. We frequently review and amend our list.

Emailing Users

Most emails sent to Users come from our automated system. They occur when you make changes to or reject a newly submitted Place. This email system is explained in detail in Part 4: New Place Approval Tasks. There are also situations that will require you to directly email a User. You are welcome to use your personal email account, or to set up a new Gmail account just for moderation emails.

If a User replies to an automated email, it will automatically be routed to the email associated with your iOverlander account. Make sure to update this email address accordingly!

If you need to directly email a user, look for the ‘Contact User’ link at the bottom of the Task page. Clicking on this button sets you up with a preformatted email addressed to the User, which you can edit to your needs.

Emails for missing information:

If a Place has missing or incomplete information, you may want to email the user. In some cases an automated emails will be sent, but other times you may want to write a custom message to better explain to the user what is needed.

When you review New Places, you will first decide whether to accept or reject the Place based on the information provided. If the Place does not meet iOverlander criteria, it will be rejected. If the Place does meet iOverlander criteria, it will be accepted (even with missing information).

Here are some common situations:

- **Wrong location.** A Place that is obviously in the wrong location (such as the wrong continent or in the middle of the ocean) should initially be rejected. However, an automated email will be sent to the user asking if they know the correct coordinates. If they reply and send new information you will need to un-delete the place and update the details.
- **Direction of travel.** In the case of entries where the direction of travel is important (such as border crossings or checkpoints) you should initially accept the Place, but it is a good idea to email the User and ask for information about the direction of travel. You will have to send a direct email, as this is not automated.

Place Descriptions vs Check-ins

All Places have one description which is meant to provide factual details about the Place. However, a Place can have many Check-ins, which contain User comments, reviews and additional information.

This is sometimes confusing because when adding new Places, the Place Description and the first Check-in are exactly the same. We do this to prevent Users from having to enter the same details twice.

When subsequent visitors add Check-ins, they also have the option to update the Place Description, if needed.

Closing Places vs 'Flag for Deletion'

Places can be either Flagged for Deletion or Closed. These are two distinct actions in iOverlander. We'll explain how to 'Close' Places and 'Flag for Deletion' in later sections: for now, you should simply understand the difference between the two terms.

Closed:

Marking a Place 'Closed' keeps the Place pin on the map, but the pin is shaded gray and a big red warning message is inserted at the top of the Place detail page. We leave the Place on the map so Users will be aware that there once was a Place in this location, but it is no longer open. This also allows users to "reopen" a Place if it was closed inadvertently.

In these instances a place should be CLOSED:

- Places that are popular (have multiple check-ins) and now for some reason are no longer available. For example a place closed because of a flood, or an owner stopped allowing camping, etc.

- If it seems like users might show up at this place (even without iOverlander), it's helpful to have a closed pin to inform travelers.
- If it seems like this place *might* reopen in the future, it's helpful to have a closed pin so travelers can reopen if the situation changes.

Change to Overnight Prohibited Category:

Places that close because camping is no longer allowed, AND that closure represents a large area where overlanders are likely to return, should be converted to the Overnight Prohibited category. For example, National Parks, USFS land, beaches, tourist attractions, popular city centers with ordinance that prohibit camping. These pins help travelers know that they can't camp in the entire area.

Flagged for Deletion:

Places that are flagged for deletion are removed from the map that users see, and are removed from search results. Flag for Deletion does not destroy the Place. It can still be viewed if a User has a direct link, and can be un-deleted by Moderators, if necessary. The Place detail page will include a big red note at the top of the page which says "This place flagged for deletion."

Wild camps and Informal Camps which are Flagged for Deletion will show on task maps as black pins. These maps are only accessible to moderators, and can prevent repeat illegal places from being added to our database.



We do not routinely destroy Places that have been flagged for deletion. These Places generally remain in the database, so they can be recalled and un-deleted, or used to make decisions about future places in the area.

These types of Places should be FLAGGED FOR DELETION:

- Places that do not meet iOverlander criteria. In New Place Approval Tasks flagging for deletion will happen automatically when you Reject a Place. This will be further explained in Part 4.
- Places that never existed in the first place – if it was in the wrong location, or a user "test", etc.
- Any Place that is reported as 'closed', and only has one Check-in. These Places are usually mistakes and were added in the wrong location to begin with. They should simply be flagged for deletion.
- **Illegal places or activities:** Any place in any category that promotes an illegal activity should be deleted. A wild camp on private property or with no camping signs, a water tap that requires a wrench to open, a shower that requires 'sneaking in'. These places should all be deleted immediately! (Sadly, many users continue to abuse these places even knowing it is illegal, so we have no choice but to delete them entirely).

Multiple Categories for One Place

If a Place falls into multiple categories (for example, a hostel that also has camping) it should have multiple pins on the map in iOverlander. Please make sure the Place is assigned to the category for which Users checked into. If multiple categories are mentioned in the check-ins then you may need to create a second Place for the second category (although this is not common). If no one has used the services of the second category, then please do not add it.

Examples:

1. A hotel may also have an established camping area out back. If all the check-ins mention camping, the category should be set to Established Campground. But, if the same Place has a check-in for a hotel room, you should add a new Place for the hotel.
2. There is a restaurant that allows informal camping in their parking lot. If there are reviews of camping in the parking lot, but no one has eaten at the restaurant, there is no need to add the place as a restaurant. Please make sure the category is Informal Camping.

To avoid overlapping points, you can manually modify the GPS coordinates to be slightly different. If you increase the 4th decimal number (00.0001 to 00.0002), the new point will be shifted approximately 10m away. If you change the 5th decimal number (00.00001 to 00.00002), the new point will be shifted approximately 1m away.

Part 3: Basic Procedures

Part 3 will teach the basics of navigating the iOverlander system. Now that you understand the types of problems to moderate, we will explain how to access your Tasks, how Tasks will be assigned, and how to interpret the My Tasks page. We'll also explain a few basic procedures that are done outside of the task system, which you may need to access occasionally.

Contents

1. Useful links
2. Logging In
3. Assignment of Tasks
4. My Tasks Page
5. Editing a Place
6. Reviewing User History
7. Editing and Deleting Check-ins
8. Editing and Deleting Images

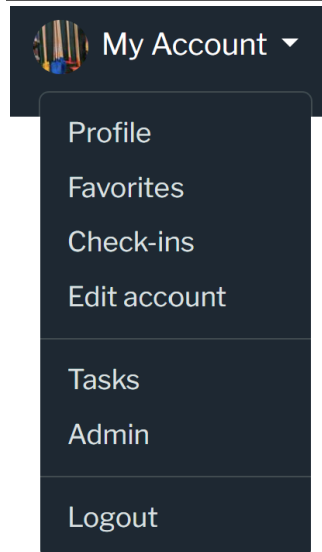
Useful Links

Here are a few useful links that you may wish to bookmark.

- All Tasks: <http://ioverlander.com/tasks>
- Your Assigned Tasks: http://ioverlander.com/tasks/my_open_tasks
- Stats of completed Tasks by moderator: <http://ioverlander.com/tasks/stats>
- [Moderator Notes](#) (Standard moderator notes)

Logging In

All moderating duties require Moderator (or Admin) level access. After your account has been given this access, you will need to log in at ioverlander.com, as you normally do when accessing the website. When you are logged in, you will see two new items under the My Account tab: Tasks and Admin.



The most important item is **Tasks**, which we will explain in detail shortly!

The [Admin page](#) also contains many links to other useful moderating tools, including links to the [Task Statistics page](#). This page shows the number of Tasks completed and number of Tasks currently assigned to Moderators. It might be fun to compare your progress with other Moderators but remember that this is not a contest! The number of Tasks completed depends very much on the type of Task assigned.

When you are logged in as a Moderator, most of your actions on the site will not generate new Tasks. Because you have this specific role, your edits to Places, edits within Tasks, and edits to images, will not create additional Tasks. If you add a new Place, or use the Report a Problem button, you will create new Tasks, but these are uncommon actions for Moderators.

Assignment of Tasks

When you begin moderating, your Coach will assign you Tasks. It is best to discuss your progress with your Coach and let him/her know when you are ready for more. Coaches usually assign 120 Tasks to each Moderator per week. However, when you are in the learning phase, you will start with fewer Tasks.

As you become a senior moderator, you may wish to assign yourself tasks. If you wish to do this, please seek permission from your coach first!

1. Go to <http://ioverlander.com/tasks>
2. Click the button at the bottom of this page that says "**Bulk Complete Trivial Tasks**". This will automatically close Tasks that do not need to be moderated. When iOverlander began, we intended to moderate every change to a Place. However, we soon realized that some small changes, such as changes to amenities, are merely trivial, and do not need to be moderated. If you are being assigned Tasks by your Coach, completion of Trivial Tasks has already been done.

Tasks

[540 unassigned tasks](#)

[8926 closed tasks](#)

[Statistics](#)

[2188 assigned tasks](#)

[Task Search](#)

[My Open Tasks](#)

[457212 completed tasks](#)

[Trivial Tasks](#)

[246 Unmoderated Images](#)

Bulk Complete Trivial Tasks



- Click on "### unassigned tasks". A new page of all unassigned Tasks will load. (See the screenshot below.) If there are no unassigned Tasks, then there is nothing to do! Come back tomorrow.
- Select the check box to the left of the Tasks you wish to assign yourself or click the box at the very top of the table to select the entire page. A page consists of 30 Tasks.

Unassigned Tasks

☐	Task	Task ID	User	Priority	Status	Description	Category	Country
☐	New Place Approval	468773	Unknown	10	unassigned	Camel Market	Tourist Attraction	Mauritania
☐	New Place Approval	468774	Unknown	10	unassigned	Checkpoint Insurance	Warning	Côte d'Ivoire
☐	New Place Approval	468777	Unknown	10	unassigned	Lago Monreal	Wild Camping	Chile
☐	New Place Approval	468778	Unknown	10	unassigned	The Flats	Hotel	El Salvador
☐	New Place Approval	468780	Unknown	10	unassigned	Rua Inês Maria de Jesus	Wild Camping	Brazil

- Scroll to the bottom of the page. Select your name from the dropdown list and click "Assign to User." This action assigns all the selected Tasks to you.

Moderator

Generic User Acct

kobus test account

Jessica Mans

Marek Cais

Jonas

Julie

Margriet en Jan

K Pawley

Raphael Favier

Matt Malone

Chad Ellis

Ueli Leardi

Bjorn Koopmans

Brian Nuttall

Ekain

lucas vogelsang

Wendy&Graham Ball

Gustavo

Esperanza

549

Unknown

10

unassigned

sacajewa scenic byway camp

551

Unknown

10

unassigned

North Fork Provincial camp

553

Unknown

10

unassigned

Highland Flats Snowmobile

554

Unknown

10

unassigned

Upper Lehman Creek Camp

555

Unknown

10

unassigned

Frank Oil Co Inc

556

Unknown

10

unassigned

Early Winters campground

-
6. You can assign yourself as many Tasks as you like but it may be easiest to work with a few Tasks or one page at a time until you are more experienced. When you have completed the assigned Tasks, you can go back and assign yourself more Tasks, depending on how much time you have available.
 7. If you have been a little too ambitious at first and you feel you may not complete all the Tasks you assigned yourself (or which have been assigned to you), just let your Coach know. The Coach will be able to reassign your Tasks accordingly.

My Tasks Page

To see your current list of assigned Tasks, visit the My Tasks page under the My Account menu:
http://ioverlander.com/tasks/my_open_tasks

***Tip:** Bookmark this page, as you will probably visit it frequently!*

The My Tasks page will look like the screenshot above except that your name will appear as the User. Let's go through the column headers:

- **Task:** This column lists the type of Task. There are five types: New Place Approval, Eliminate Duplicates, Place Corrections, Flagged Checkins and Place Issues. If you click on the Task name or the Description of the Task, the Task will be opened in a new page.
- **Task ID:** This column lists the unique Task ID number. If you need to ask questions about a task be sure to include this number.
- **User:** This is the person to whom the Task is currently assigned. All Tasks will be assigned to Moderators, like you. (The term 'User' on this page refers to Moderators. Otherwise, we refer to Overlanders as Users.)
- **Priority:** Tasks are sorted by priority. 'New Place Approvals' are top priority and the greatest number of Tasks are in this category.
- **Status:** Normally this field will only say "assigned". When a Task is completed, the status changes to "completed", but the Task is also automatically removed from your list. Therefore, you only see the status as "assigned".
- **Description:** The description column lists the name of the Place related to the Task. If you click on the description it will open the Task. There can be several Tasks for one Place and it is usually easy to recognize this by browsing the Descriptions column.
- **Category:** The category of the Place (eg restaurant, wild camping) is listed here.
- **Country:** The country for the Place is listed in this column.

Editing a Place

You may need to go back to a Place to do some further editing based on information you acquire from another source such as Check-ins, Issue reports, or anything else you observe while moderating.

1. To edit a Place you must be logged in to ioverlander.com.
2. Go to the Place detail page of the Place you want to edit. Here's an example of a link that will take you to a Place detail page: <http://ioverlander.com/places/7307-wild-oats-farmer-s-market>
3. Go to the bottom left corner of the Place detail page. You will see a set of links that look like this:

[Edit](#) | [Flag Deleted](#) | [Issue](#)

4. Click the Edit link, which will open a new page. This page will allow you to edit every field of the Place.
5. Edit as needed. Note that when a Place is edited using this Edit link, no Tasks are created.
6. Don't forget to click SUBMIT at the bottom of the Place detail page or you will lose all your edits.

Reviewing User History

Sometimes it is necessary to examine a User's history, which means reviewing all Places and Check-ins contributed by that User. For example, you may note a problem (e.g. profanity) in a Place description and this might prompt you to investigate whether the same User might be repeating the mistake in other submissions.

1. First go to the User's blog account page. The easiest way to get to this page is to go to the Place detail page where the Check-in is listed and then click on the User's name displayed with their Check-in. For example, clicking on the highlighted names below will take you to the blog account pages for those Users.

I've been here, check me in

Why? By checking in after you've visited a place you let others know this place is still functional. You can also add or correct any information.

♥ Add to Favorites

Latest Check-Ins

[February 7th, 2025](#) by [Escaping Normal Life](#) 

[Contact User](#)

Propane fill-ups at Tractor Supply. \$3.89/gallon as of 1/25.

[Report Check-In](#)

2. When you are on the blog account page, click on the link "Contributed # Check-Ins". This will load a page of all the User's Check-ins.
-

 [Escaping Normal Life](#)

Full Time in a Subaru Forester
Created By [Escaping Normal Life](#)

[Contributed 342 Images](#)

[Contributed 146 Places](#)

[Contributed 264 Check-Ins](#)

Search for Duplicate Places

Fix Check-in Dates

[Edit](#) | [Back](#)

3. Read through and review the Check-ins to see if there are any Check-ins to be edited or deleted.

Note: Some users may have hundreds of Check-ins. In this case it is not necessary to review every one of them! Simply read through the first page to see if the mistake has been repeated, if not, it was likely a one-time occurrence and there is no need to continue investigating.

Editing and Deleting Check-ins

There have been many references to Check-ins in the sections above and in Part 2. You already know that Check-Ins are the comments and reviews that Users are encouraged to submit every time they visit a Place.

Check-ins are not moderated in a systematic way as there are simply too many Check-ins to make this type of review feasible. But sometimes it is necessary to edit or delete Check-ins, especially if you have found problems when reviewing a User's history.

To Edit a Check-in:

1. Follow the steps in the previous section to access the User's blog account page. When you are on the blog account page, click on the link "Contributed # Check-Ins". This will load a page of all the User's check-ins.
2. On the list of Check-ins, search for the one that needs editing. Some Overlanders have been using our site for many years and they may have contributed hundreds of Check-Ins. It's a good idea to know the date of the Check-in to find the one that needs your attention!

Escaping Normal Life Check-Ins

Date	Place	Comment	
February 7th, 2025	Tractor Supply	Propane fill-ups at Tractor Supply. \$3.89/gallon as of 1/25.	Edit Check-In Correct Place Delete Check-In
January 21st, 2025	Buckeye Public Library- Coyote Branch	free wifi inside the library. not the fastest, but free. several desks with power outlets to work from. 3.8mbps down, 4mbps up.	Edit Check-In Correct Place Delete Check-In
January 19th, 2025	Starbucks	not the fastest wifi, but free. Starbucks has a decent amount of tables inside and out to work from. outlets in several places by the tables to plug in. 9.3mbps down, 6mbps up.	Edit Check-In Correct Place Delete Check-In
January 17th, 2025	Crite Library	Free public wifi at the Crite library. not the fastest wifi, but free. 9.7mbps down, 17mbps up. Took me almost 3hrs to upload a 19 minute, 4k video to youtube. a few desks with some nearby power outlets to work from hours: M T W T F	Edit Check-In Correct Place Delete Check-In

3. When you locate the Check-in that needs editing, click the "Edit Check-In" link which you can see in the screenshot above on the right side of the page. This will open the Check-in as an editable area. You can change the text as needed (to remove a wifi password, profanity, etc).

Editing Check-In

Place

314657

Comment *

Propane fill-ups at Tractor Supply. \$3.89/gallon as of 1/25.

Visited

2025 ▾

February ▾

7 ▾

Save

[Show](#) | [Back](#)

4. Don't forget to click on the SAVE button or you will lose your work!

To Delete a Check-in:

Deleting a Check-in is permanent! This action cannot be undone.

1. In the list of Check-ins, you will also see a link to Delete a Check-in on the right side of the page.

Escaping Normal Life Check-Ins

Date	Place	Comment	
February 7th, 2025	Tractor Supply	Propane fill-ups at Tractor Supply. \$3.89/gallon as of 1/25.	Edit Check-In Correct Place Delete Check-In
January 21st, 2025	Buckeye Public Library- Coyote Branch	free wifi inside the library. not the fastest, but free. several desks with power outlets to work from. 3.8mbps down, 4mbps up.	Edit Check-In Correct Place Delete Check-In

This action is sometimes requested by the Users themselves (maybe they made a mistake or entered the Check-in twice) and the User may not realize that they can delete their own Check-ins.

Editing and Deleting Images

To Edit a Photo:

1. Click on the image to open the Image Editing Page. For example, if you are on this Place Detail page: <http://ioverlander.com/places/64538-iris-urrutia>, simply click on the big image to load this editing page: <http://ioverlander.com/images/58241> (Note that the URLs include the Place ID number and Image ID number, respectively.)

Tip: It is easiest to open each image in a new tab, especially if you are on slower internet. Right-click the image and select "Open in a new Tab". Or hold CTRL and left click on the image.

2. You can rotate the image if necessary. In the Image Editing Page, you will see a large image, and there are three buttons above it, as shown below. Click the appropriate button to rotate the image.

Rotate Clockwise

Rotate Counter Clockwise

Rotate 180

3. After you click on the selected button, you will see a note at the top of the page that the image is reprocessing, as shown below.

Image is reprocessing.

4. The page should reload when the reprocessing is complete. However, sometimes this does not happen. In this case, you will need to refresh the page again to make sure the change has taken effect. Press the refresh button on your browser  or F5 on your keyboard, to refresh your page.

Tip: If you are on slower internet, this process can be painful. We're sorry, and we are working on it! This is why we recommend opening images in a new tab, so that while the image is reprocessing, you can continue to work on other Tasks.

To Delete a Photo:

Deleting an image is permanent. This action cannot be undone!

1. You can also delete images. First, follow step 1 above to access an Image Editing Page. Then scroll to the bottom of the page and click destroy as shown below.



Part 4: New Place Approval Tasks (Task Type 1)

The most frequent type of Tasks you will be moderating are New Place Approvals. iOverlander receives approximately 150 new Places every day! New places are visible to all Users as soon as they are submitted. However, after submission, each Place is subject to moderation and may be edited or removed. The goal is for a Moderator to review the new Place and make sure it meets iOverlander Criteria and General Rules.

New Place Approval Tasks are particularly important as this is the first time (and it might be the only time) that a Place will be moderated.

Basic Steps for New Place Approval Tasks

These are the basic steps for completing New Place Approval Tasks. A detailed description follows in the next section.

1. Make sure you are logged on to iOverlander and then navigate to your My Tasks list.
(http://ioverlander.com/tasks/my_open_tasks)
2. Click on the name of the Task, “New Place Approval”, to open the Task.
3. Review all of the details about the Place, and determine if the Place meets the Criteria for Acceptance, and does not violate any of our General Rules (as explained in Parts 1 & 2)
4. Make any edits to the Place, if needed.
5. Add Moderator Notes to the Place description, if required.
6. Check boxes to notify the user or changes or rejections, if required.
7. Click the buttons to Accept or Reject the place, depending on your decision.

Procedures for New Place Approval

1. In your list of Tasks, click on the name of the Task or the description of the Task to open it. Of course, it is easiest to start at the top and work through the list systematically!

TIP: If you are on slower internet, it may be faster to open multiple Tasks at one time. Hold down the CTRL key and click the names of the Tasks. (Or, right-click on each Task and select 'open in a new tab'). You can review each Task in the open tab, follow all the procedures described below, and close the tab when the Task is completed.

2. Below is an example of a typical Task page for a new place in the Wild Camping category. We're only showing the top of the page to begin with:

The screenshot shows a web browser window with the URL iOverlander.com/tasks/139048. The page header includes the iOverlander logo and navigation links: Find Places, Add Places, Apps, Resources, About, and My Account. The task details are as follows:

Task type:	User:	Priority:	Task Status:
New Place Approval	Life Remotely	10	assigned

Below the task details, there is a section for "Linked Issues" which states "There are no issues linked to this task." This is followed by the text "New Place Approval For: [Höchhand](#)".

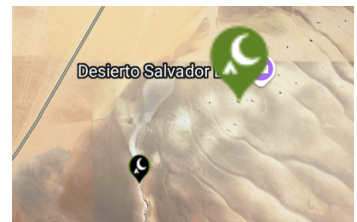
The main content area features a satellite map of a mountainous region. A green location pin marks the spot for "Höchhand". Other nearby locations labeled on the map include "Bergrestaurant Poo-Alp" (marked as temporarily closed), "Berggasthaus Chrüzegg", "Restaurant Sonne", and "Restaurant Alp Aitschwand". The map includes standard controls like a zoom in/out button and a street view pegman. At the bottom of the map, it says "Other Wild Camping places within 4km: 1".

3. Note that the Task number is in the URL (139048). You will need to copy this URL if you want to discuss any problems about this Task with your Coach or add it to the training log.

4. The top gray bar will show you the Task type, the User to whom the Task is assigned, the Task priority and the Task status. Usually these fields will not change (i.e. you will always be the User and the Task status will be 'assigned').
5. The Place name will be listed in large blue letters: in this example it is 'Höchhand'. If you click on this name, the Place Detail page will open in a new tab. This is the page that all Users see. (In our example, the place detail page is: <http://ioverlander.com/places/130084-hochhand>). Note that on the Place Detail page, the URL now includes the Place number (130084). It's very rare that you will need to view a Place Detail page, as almost all edits can be made from the Task page.
6. The map on this page will show you other iOverlander pins. The place you are reviewing will be the largest pin on the map. In our example there are no other iOverlander places.

There are a few things you might want to review, related to maps, including:

- **Deleted Pins:** Previously deleted informal or wild camps will show on the map as black pins. Click on these black pins to show more details about the deleted place. These may indicate that camping in the area is illegal, and the place should be rejected.
- **Country and Coordinate mis-match:** Our system will automatically reverse geocode the GPS coordinates entered to detect the country and we compare this with the country that the user selected. If these do not match, you will see a big red warning on top of the task:



This place's country (Canada) doesn't match the country of the GPS coordinates (United States).

If you see this warning, review the coordinates and country fields carefully. Most of the time this is a simple user error, where they crossed a border and forgot to update their country. However, sometimes this is a larger problem with GPS coordinates (see next bullet). Note that our reverse geocoder is NOT perfect. Sometimes (especially near borders or water, it will detect the wrong country. If this is the case, ignore the warning.

- **GPS coordinates:** A common problem is that a User submits GPS coordinates without including the negative sign and the pin may show up in the middle of a large body of water or on another continent! You can change the coordinates further down on the page in the latitude and longitude boxes.
 - If the Place is clearly in the wrong location, and you are not able to correct the coordinates, the Place must be rejected. With our notification system, the User will have the opportunity to provide updated coordinates.
- **Large campgrounds:** If the pin is in a large camping area, it can be helpful to move the pin to the campground entrance. It is easiest to open the location in google maps, and copy the correct coordinate, and then return to the Task page to add the new location. (We are working on making our pins "draggable" in tasks, so this is easier!)
- **Nearby Places of the same category:** Note the extremely useful feature at the base of the map on the Task page. This feature informs you of how many Places of the same category are within a 4km distance. Some categories, like Restaurants, require a different assessment depending how many nearby Places exist. Be sure to reread the Criteria in Part 1 if this information is not clear.

7. Further down the Task page, you will see a set of boxes with all the descriptive fields and amenities of the Place, which will look like the screenshot below. You can edit any of the text in the boxes.

Place category	Wild Camping	Country	Switzerland
Name	Höchhand	Date verified	2020 May 2
Description	<input "tössbergland"="" 1h="" :)."="" a="" alp="" also="" and="" bike.="" breathtaking.="" campers="" flat="" for="" from="" he's="" is="" just="" known.="" lot="" next="" not="" of="" ok="" one="" over="" owner="" parking="" plenty="" short="" space="" talked="" tents.="" the="" to="" top="" type="text" tössbergland"="" value="highest peak of the " very="" view="" walk="" we="" well="" whole="" wild="" with=""/>		
Electricity	No	Open for business	Yes
Kitchen	No	Restaurant	No
Water	Non-Potable	Restroom	No
Tent friendly	Yes	Pet friendly	Yes
		Internet	No
		Showers	No
		Big rig friendly	No
		Place Website	

Let's consider the boxes in the order they appear on the page.

- **Place category:** It is important to make sure that Places are in the correct category (according to the definitions in Part 1.) Here are common category problems:
 - The type of campground is incorrect.
 - A hotel/hostel, fuel station or restaurant where someone camped or slept in their vehicle overnight should be categorized as an Informal Campground.
 - Customs, Checkpoints and Warnings categories are often confused.
 - The OTHER category is used frequently for tourist attractions, wifi, laundry and showers. These are newly added categories and not all travelers are aware they exist.
- **Country:** Yes, sometimes the assigned country is wrong. (Perhaps the User clicked the wrong button too quickly!) Take a quick look at the map, and if the location looks suspicious, zoom out to make sure the country is correct.
- **Date Verified:** This field can be ignored. It is the date of the most recent Check-in. If the date is months or even years in the past, it is usually because the User waited a long time to sync their information.
- **Name:** The goal for a Place name is to be short and relevant. Excessively long descriptive names should be edited. For example: A wild camping Place with a suggested name of 'free wild camp near the beach with a great view', could be edited to 'Near the beach'. The terms 'free' and 'great view' could be moved to the description.

Place names should usually NOT be translated because they are the official name of the place in the local language. These should be left as-is so Users can easily locate the place. If the name is NOT in the local language or English, it should be translated. If in doubt do NOT translate.

TIP: If an Informal Camping Place is part of a Hotel, Hostel, Restaurant or Fuel Station, it's helpful to include this designation in the Place Name to clarify the type of establishment and the location.

- **Description:** To tackle this important section of the Task page, you must be familiar [Parts 1](#) and [Part 2](#) of this Guide. Follow the guidance for Moderator Notes and Emailing Users, which may be necessary when you find problems in the descriptions. This section of the Task page will probably take most of your moderating time.

Remember to look out for:

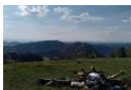
- Foreign Languages
 - Promotional Links
 - Places added by Owners/Managers
 - Profanity or Nasty Language
 - Wifi Passwords
 - Emojis & Emoticons
- **Place Website (and phone):** This space is intended for the office website of the Place. Sometimes Users enter their own personal Blog URL, and these should be deleted. If the information is in the place description please copy it over to the relevant field.
 - **Open (yes/no):** This box allows you to mark a Place as open or closed. For New Place Approval Tasks, it should generally be left alone.
 - **Amenities** (all the other boxes on the page!): If the Place is a Camping Place or a Hotel or Hostel, there will be as many amenities, as in the screenshot above. Other categories of Places have fewer or no amenities. Have a quick look to determine if there are any discrepancies with the description. Don't spend a lot of time on this item as Users who later submit Check-ins for the Place will be prompted to review the amenities.

8. Moving further down the Task page, we see the following section which displays all Check-ins and photos for the Place under consideration:

Check-Ins:

- [muellerjpe1 on May 2nd, 2020](#): highest peak of the "Tössbergland" and not very well known. the top is flat and plenty of space for tents. the view over the whole "tössbergland" is breathtaking. 1h walk from the next parking lot and just a short one with a bike. we also talked to the owner of the alp and he's ok with wild campers :).

Photos:



-
- **Check-Ins:**

- With New Place Approval Tasks, you will normally only see one Check-in which is a duplicate of the Place Description. It is usually acceptable if the Check-in text is different from the text you have edited for the Place description. (Check-ins do NOT require translating, editing or removal of emoticons.) However, if there is a wifi password or profanity in the Place description, you must also edit the Check-in. Don't forget to do this! (See the instructions for editing Check-ins in [Part 3](#).)
- Pay close attention to New Place Approvals that have **more than one Check-in** listed. Because new Places 'go live' (appear on the map) immediately, a subsequent User occasionally reports a problem before the Place has gone through the moderation queue. For example, a second User may leave Check-in saying, "I couldn't find this place" or "Owner would not let us camp". You will have to take these additional Check-ins into account in your review process.
- **Photos:**
 - Review photos to make sure they meet the Rules outlined in [Part 2](#). It is common to find duplicate images and incorrectly rotated images which will need to be individually corrected. We recommend you open each image that needs to be corrected in a new tab. Follow the instructions in [Part 3](#), for more information on photo/image editing.

9. At the bottom of the Task page, you will see the options for Notifying the User about changes or a rejection.

Notify User:

Moderators: Checkmark the changes you made to this place, if any. This will send an autogenerated email to the user explaining your edits and or/why the place was rejected. If you want to accept with no edits, check nothing, click accept, and no email will be sent.

Accept this place, with edits:

- ☐ Category Changed
- ☐ Translated to English
- ☐ Deleted WiFi Password
- ☐ Removed Personal Website
- ☐ Restaurant - Average quality, warning to improve
- ☐ Other - Enter custom message below

Reject this place, because:

- ☐ Wrong Location
- ☐ Illegal Camping
- ☐ Temporary Place
- ☐ Road Report
- ☐ Missing critical information
- ☐ Description is poor quality
- ☐ Inappropriate content
- ☐ Did not investigate / stay the night
- ☐ Other - does not meet criteria
- ☐ Restaurants - Poor Description

Add a custom message to the user:

For this message to send, you must check at least one box above

Accept

Reject

[Contact User](#)
[My Open Tasks](#) | [Edit](#)

- If you intend to accept the Place, but have made changes, look in the left side column. Check any boxes that apply. This will send an email to the user, letting them know about the changes. This is important because it prevents future errors.
- If you intend to reject the place, select the checkboxes next to the reasons for rejecting. If there are multiple reasons for rejecting the place, you can check more than one box. The system will only send one email, which will list the multiple reasons for the rejection.
- If you reject a place for a reason that is NOT in the list, check the “Other – Does not meet criteria” checkbox and use the custom message box to explain to the user why their place is being rejected.
- Use the comment box to explain to travelers WHY their place is being rejected, especially if the reason is not obvious (is a coordinate putting the place in the ocean, a missing phone number, a weird piece of criteria that’s unclear!) **Be overly polite** and educate users. Our criteria exists to help travelers, but it is complicated and oftentimes frustrating. Educate them and travelers will be our best advocates!

IMPORTANT NOTES REGARDING AUTO EMAILS:

- Full text for the emails, and the reasons are included in the [appendix](#). READ THIS BEFORE YOU CHECK A BOX! This way you know what is being sent to Travelers.
- Although emails are sent from our automated system, if a user replies it will be routed to the email address associated with **your iOverlander account**. CHECK THIS IS A VALID EMAIL ADDRESS! Some emails ask the user to reply with more information (for example, if the location is incorrect)
- If you do not want the system to send an email, then simply do not check any boxes. (for example, if you have already sent this user emails for other places, there is no need to keep sending them the same message!)

10. At the bottom of the Task page, you will see the options for accepting or rejecting the Task.



[Contact User](#)
[My Open Tasks](#) | [Edit](#) | [Back](#)

- If you are satisfied that the Place meets iOverlander Criteria, you can click Accept. This will implement any changes/edits you have made and will complete the Task.
- If the Place does not meet iOverlander Criteria, you will click Reject. Always remember that if you Reject a Place, **you must** include a [Moderator Note](#) in the description explaining why it was rejected. Rejection will automatically cause the place to be ‘Flagged for Deletion’.
- If you are unsure about whether to Accept or Reject, contact your Coach for advice. It’s ok to leave a Task open and skip to the next Task while waiting for more guidance.

11. After clicking Accept or Reject, the next task in your My Tasks List will automatically load. You will see a green bar at the top of the page that says “Next task ready”.

Next task ready

Tip: If you have opened Tasks in multiple tabs, you should close the current tab and skip to the next one.

12. If you need to skip a Task, return to your [My Task page](#), and manually select the next Task in your list after the one you have skipped.
13. When all your Tasks are completed, you will automatically be redirected to your My Tasks Page, with a notification that says “You have no tasks currently assigned to you”.

Other Helpful Advice

Following is some helpful advice from other moderators.

TIP: By now, you are probably noticing that you must keep an eye on the URL (screen identification bar). This URL gives you ID numbers, of which there are plenty! There are Task numbers, Place numbers, Location numbers, Image numbers, User numbers, etc. Try not to get them confused. Most commonly, Task numbers and Place numbers are confused, as they are very similar.

TIP: You will notice that we frequently refer to several different pages: Place Detail pages, Place Edit pages, Task pages, Image Editing pages. This will all come easily to you when you have completed a few Tasks!

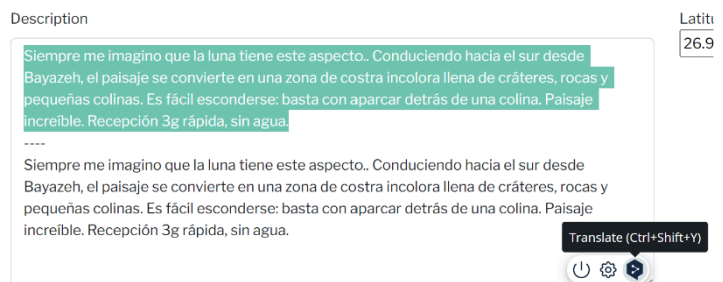
TIP: If you change your mind about any decisions, or you remember something you may have forgotten, or you make a mistake, you may need to re-open the Task. If you recently completed the task, you can use your browser history to locate the task. You will be given the option to reopen the task if needed.

If you can't locate the task in your browser history, go to the Task search page and search by completed tasks: <http://ioverlander.com/tasks/search>.

TIP: There are several browser extensions that make translations much faster.

DeepL: <https://www.deepl.com/en/app/>

DeepL has browser extensions for chrome, edge and firefox. When enabled,



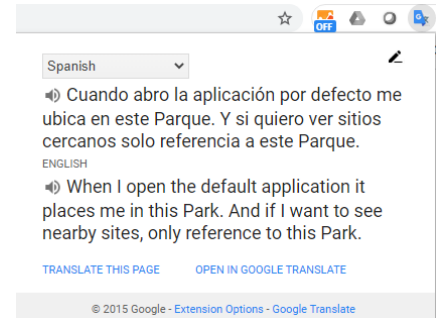
it will add an icon to the bottom left of the description box to quickly translate text. Remember to COPY the original text to save the foreign language entry.

Google Translate:

If you are using Chrome as your browser, you can install the Google Translate Extension here:

<https://chrome.google.com/webstore/detail/google-translate/aapbdbdomjkkjkaonfhkkikfgjllcleb/related>

This will allow you to quickly translate text by clicking a button on the top of your browser bar, without having to open Google Translate in a new tab.



NEW MODERATORS STOP HERE!

Please contact your Coach to begin moderating.

You are welcome to continue reading, however the remainder of this Guide contains information on other Task types and advanced procedures, which you will not need initially.

Part 5: Eliminate Duplicates (Task Type 2)

This Part describes the procedures for completing 'Eliminate Duplicates' Tasks. Duplicate Places can be reported by Users or they can be detected automatically by the iOverlander system if the Places are within 50 meters of each other. Your goal for this Task type is to determine if the two Places listed are duplicates of each other and should be merged or if they should remain as unique Places.

When we flag duplicates:

- Two places within 10m of each other IF:
 - Either place is accommodation (camping, hotels, hostels) or a restaurant
 - They are NOT added by the same user, and are not both the same category (prevents a place that fits into multiple categories being flagged.)
 - They are NOT already marked as a duplicate of another place (prevents multiple duplicate tasks for the same point)
- Places within 50m of each other if:
 - Neither place is a restaurant. (prevents loads of restaurants in big cities being flagged)
 - Both are in the SAME category. (prevents flagging similar businesses in dif categories)
 - Same category is not required for all camping and hotels, but the potential duplicate must also be camping or hotel. (e.g a hotel and hostel can be duplicates, but a hotel and a fuel station cannot.)
 - They are NOT added by the same user

We do NOT flag:

- Places that are more than 50m apart

How 'Eliminate Duplicate' Tasks are created

'Eliminate Duplicates' Tasks are created in two different ways:

1. A User reports a Place as a duplicate, using the "Report a Problem" (RAP) button. This will generate an 'Eliminate Duplicates' Task. The majority of duplicates reported by Users are, in fact, duplicates, and the Moderator should merge the Places as per the instructions below.

2. If a new Place is added by a User and the Place is within 50 meters of another Place in the same or similar category, an 'Eliminate Duplicates' Task will be created automatically. If the Task was autogenerated by the system, the Places are duplicates about 50% of the time.

There are exceptions for both situations: hence the need for Moderators!

Basic Steps for Eliminate Duplicate Tasks

1. Make sure you are logged on to iOverlander and navigate to your My Tasks list.
(http://ioverlander.com/tasks/my_open_tasks)
2. Click on the name of the Task, "Eliminate Duplicate", to open the Task.
3. Check the "Linked Issues" table to see if the duplicate was reported by the system or by a User.
4. Compare the two Places reported as duplicates and determine if they are the same Place.
5. If they are the same Place, make any edits needed to the merged value column.
6. Click the Merge or Not Duplicates buttons at the bottom of the page to complete the Task.

Procedures for Eliminating Duplicate Tasks

Remember that your goal for this Task type is to determine if the two Places listed are in fact the same Place. There are many ways to determine if two Places are duplicates.

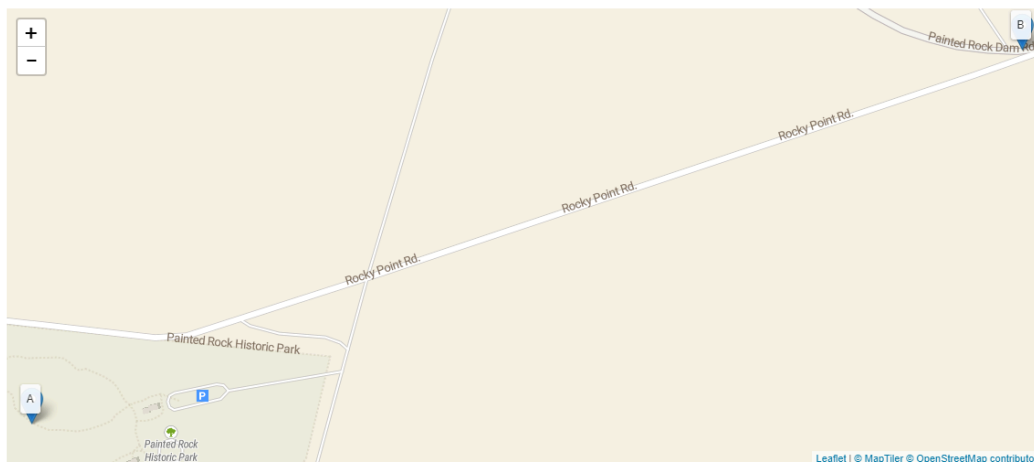
1. The upper part of the Task page in the 'Eliminate Duplicates' category" will appear as follows:
-

Task type: Eliminate Duplicates	User: Wendy&Graham Ball	Priority: 7	Task Status: assigned
---------------------------------	-------------------------	-------------	-----------------------

Linked Issues:

Date Reported	Reported By	Issue Status	Reference Task ID	Issue Type	User Comment	Contact User
2020-05-17	welovetoeexplore.com	open	139520	Place is a Duplicate	This place is a duplicate of Painted Rock Petroglyphs Campground BLM (1.2 km West)	Contact User

Eliminate Duplicates for: [Painted Rock Petroglyphs Campground BLM](#) & [Painted Rock Petroglyphs](#)



- The top gray bar will show you the Task type, the User to whom the Task is assigned, the Task priority and the Task status. Most of the time these fields will not change. (eg, you will always be the User and the Task status will be indicated as 'assigned').
- Just under the gray bar, you will see a section for Linked Issues. Remember that Issues are User Reported Problems.

In the example shown above, there is a Linked Issue which indicates that the Duplicate was reported by a User. There will be a link to the "Issue" that was also created but you do not need to visit the Issue page. When you complete the Eliminate Duplicates Task the Issue will **automatically be closed!** If the Duplicate was indeed reported by a User, you will err on the side of merging the information in the two Places.

If there are no linked Issues the Task page will simply display this:

Linked Issues: There are no issues linked to this task.

- Moving down the page, you will see a map that shows both Places. You can use the map to consider the following:

- Are the Places close together? (The distance between the Places is listed immediately below the map.) Places that are less than 20m apart are more likely to be duplicates than Places that are 20km apart. Rarely are Places that are more than 5km apart duplicates.
 - If the Places are not close together, is it because the Places are in a very large camping area and the descriptions are actually referring to the same campground? Or is the Place in a city where Places that look close together are actually in different buildings?
5. Continuing down the Task page, you may see photos of the two Places, if such photos exist! Is one a remote campground and the other a busy city street? Use the photos as clues to determine if the Places are duplicates.
6. Below the map you will see a table with four columns (as shown in the screenshot below):
- Column 1 lists the Fields being compared for the two Places.
 - Column 2 lists the value in each field for the first potential duplicate. Place A is always the Place that was added to our database first!
 - Column 3 lists the value in each field for the second potential duplicate, Place B.
 - Column 4 lists the merged value. For amenities, the most recently verified value is used, for the rest of the fields the value from Place A is used by default. You can select the best value and make changes in any of these fields. The values in this column will be the values that remain if you **MERGE** the two Places.

Place A: Painted Rock Petroglyphs Campground BLM - Place B: Painted Rock Petroglyph site			
Field	Place A	Place B	Merged Value
Name	Painted Rock Petroglyphs Campground BLM	Painted Rock Petroglyph site	Painted Rock Petroglyphs Campground BLM
Original Contributor	Song of the Road	loshierhome	
Category	Established Campground	Established Campground	Established Campground ▼
Location	33.022905, -113.049314	33.026585, -113.037676	Latitude: 33.0229050619835 Longitude: -113.049314059422
Altitude	173.0	188.577419281006	173.0
Country	United States	United States	United States ▼
Last Visited	May 17th, 2020	March 18th, 2019	2020 ▼ May ▼ 17 ▼
Description	So the pros: only 10 miles off freeway on our way home to CA. We had the place to ourselves. We did not pay to camp here since we were totally alone. Cons: hot as hell. No seriously, June 1 it was 104 after dark. Pit toilet, picnic tables, trash cans and fire pits are amenities. No water! Official price is \$8 to camp and \$4 with a Annual Parks Pass. Petroglyphs are not worth the visit unless you need to camp here.	Nice clean campground, quiet, buggy and no water	So the pros: only 10 miles off freeway on our way home to CA. We had the place to ourselves. We did not pay to camp here since we were totally alone. Cons: hot as hell. No seriously, June 1 it was 104 after dark. Pit toilet, picnic
Place Website			
Open	Yes	Yes	Yes ▼

7. You should compare the middle two columns (Place A and Place B) to determine if the Places are actually duplicates. You may want to consider:

- Are the names the same or similar?
- Are the categories the same? This is the most likely reason that two very similar Places should not be merged. For example, you would not merge a hotel with a campground. Even if the campground is part of the hotel, we keep these Places separate in iOverlander. See Part 2 for details on [Places which fit into multiple categories](#).
- Read the Place Descriptions! Do the Place descriptions appear to be referring to the same Place? Does the description perhaps clarify why the Places are or are not duplicates?

In our example above, the Places are clearly duplicates and should be merged. The names, descriptions and categories are very similar. Even though the markers are a kilometer apart, there is nothing else on the map to indicate that these pins are for two different Places. In addition, this case was a User-reported duplicate, so we should trust that the User visited this area and knows that there aren't two campgrounds here!

8. If you decide that the Places are indeed duplicates, you must select the best details for the two Places. You will need to update the values in the last column to describe the best possible value. Let's consider a few items in these columns:

- **Place name:** The merger automatically selects the name and description from Place A. But this is not always the best, or the most accurate. If they have different names, but you are not sure which is correct, enter both names with a dash between the names.
- **Last Visited: Please do not change this field:** it is automatically set to display the most recent date each Place has been verified or visited by a User. In the example shown above, the last date verified for Place A indicates that a Check-in was added by a User more recently than the original Place was added.
- **Description:** If you decide that the Places are duplicates, read and compare the descriptions carefully to determine if the text in the Merged Value column is the best possible description. You may want to copy information from Place B and paste it into the merged description in the last column, or edit the merged value of neither A nor B is correct. If the descriptions are contradictory, use the information from the Place that has the most recent date visited.

9. Looking at the bottom half of the Task page, you will see the amenity fields as in the screenshot below. You can edit these fields if necessary, but usually the system does a good job auto-selecting the best value.

Open	Yes	Yes	Yes ▾
Electricity	No	No	No ▾
Wifi	No	No	No ▾
Kitchen	No	No	No ▾
Restaurant	No	No	No ▾
Showers	No	No	No ▾
Water	No	No	No ▾
Toilets	Pit Toilets	Pit Toilets	Pit Toilets ▾
Big Rig Friendly	Yes	Yes	Yes ▾
Tent Friendly	Yes	Yes	Yes ▾
Pet Friendly	Yes	Yes	Yes ▾

10. At the very bottom of this page, you will have to decide whether to Merge the Information or mark the Places as Not Duplicates.



- If you decide to Merge, simply click the green Merge button at the bottom of the page. The duplicate Place will be hidden from Users, and the new Place will be updated with all of the values which you have edited in the last column of the table.
- If you decide that the Places are not duplicates, go to the bottom of the Task page and click “Not Duplicates”. Do not update the descriptions and do not enter any additional information. This action will ensure that both Places remain separate in the database.

Part 6: Place Correction Tasks (Task Type 3)

Every time a User checks-in to a Place on iOverlander, the User is asked to verify all of the information about the Place. The User can update GPS coordinates, the Place name, description, amenities, etc. They can also mark a Place closed. All of these actions generate Place Correction Tasks.

Your goal for Place Correction Tasks is to determine whether the corrections proposed by the User should be permanently entered into the iOverlander database. Of course, you will need to confirm that the changes do not violate any of our Criteria or General Rules. (See Parts 1 & 2.)

Place corrections are applied to a Place the instant a User submits a correction. If a Moderator chooses to "Apply Corrections", the Moderator is simply confirming that those corrections can remain permanently in the database. If a Moderator selects "Discard Corrections", the corrections will be thrown out and the Place details will revert back to the original. This process ensures that User corrections are 'live' as soon as possible. Because such a large percentage of corrections are approved, we do not worry about the brief amount of time that incorrect information might exist on the database: the information will be corrected fairly quickly!

Note that when a Moderator edits a place using the 'Edit' button or by making changes directly in a Task, a Place Correction Task is not created.

Basic Steps for Place Correction Tasks

Below are the basic steps for completing Place Correction Tasks.

1. Make sure you are logged on to iOverlander and navigate to your My Tasks list.
(http://ioverlander.com/tasks/my_open_tasks)
2. Click the name of the Task - "Place Correction" - to open the Task. This will load the Place Correction Task page.
3. Review the Proposed Changes and determine if you will accept or reject them. To make this decision and to become familiar with the Place Correction Task page, please read the next section carefully.
4. If necessary, review other information on the Place Correction page, including details about the Place, recent Check-ins, or look for Other Tasks related to this Place.
5. Make any edits to the Place, if needed.
6. Add Moderator Notes to the Place Description and/or email the User, if needed.
7. Finally, click Apply Corrections or Discard Corrections.

Procedures for Place Correction Tasks

Let's go through the specific procedures for Place Correction Tasks by carefully reviewing the Task page.

1. The top section of a typical Place Correction Task page will look like the screenshot shown below.



iOverlander
Find your next destination

[Find Places](#) ▾ [Add Places](#) ▾ [iOverlander App](#) [Donate](#) ▾ [Resources](#) ▾ [About](#) ▾ [My Account](#) ▾

Task type: Place Corrections **User:** Jessica Mans **Priority:** 5 **Task Status:** assigned

Linked Issues: There are no issues linked to this task.

Place Correction for: [Mile 14 Camping](#)

Submitted by: [borisament76 \(troopyblog.wordpress.com\)](#)

- The top gray bar will show you the Task type, the assigned User, the Task priority and the Task status. Usually, these fields will not change.
- Next you will see a section for Linked Issues. Remember that Issues are User-Reported Problems. When you are completing Place Correction Tasks, you can ignore Linked Issues and complete the Task regardless of whether or not Linked Issues exist.
- The Place name in our example is 'Mile 14 Camping'. As with any Task type, if you click on the name, the Place Detail page will open. You normally do not need to view a Place Detail page, but occasionally it is necessary to make changes that are not possible within the Task page. (See Part 3 for details.)
- The 'Submitted by' field will show you the name of the User who submitted the correction. The User's blog or website follows in parentheses. This information may give you a clue as to whether or not the proposed change was submitted by an overlander or an owner/manager. This is important to know because managers/owners are not supposed to make certain changes to their Place descriptions, such as removing Moderator notes.

2. Next on the Task page, you will see a Table of Proposed Changes to the Place.

Review these proposed changes:

If there are additional changes in the Current Value column, subsequent edits have occurred after this task was created. Check for other open tasks for this place at the bottom of the page.

Property	Old Value	Proposed Value	Current Value with most recent changes
name	Mile 14 Camping	Windpomp 14	No additional changes submitted.
description	230n\$ per night. New place on the beach. Nice bar and restaurant with great showers, it's like a spa. Amazing hosts and super friendly staff. Power and water on site. Seasonal camping. All Black supporters welcome!	There are 21 big sandy sites with their own private ablution. Inside is a toilet, small kitchen with big fridge/freezer, a one pit burner stove, sink and shower area with sink. Outside a fireplace for braai and covered seating area. In	There are 21 big sandy sites with their own private ablution. Inside is a toilet, small kitchen with big fridge/freezer, a one pit burner stove, sink and shower area with sink. Outside a fireplace for braai and covered seating area. In

The Table of Proposed Changes shows the corrections that have been made to the Place. There are four columns, as follows:

- **Property:** This column lists the fields that have been changed.
- **Old Value:** This column shows the original entry for the property/field. The entry is what the property/field was set at the time The Task was created and before the correction was made.
- **Proposed Value:** This column shows the new proposed correction. This is what you need to review carefully!
- **Current Value with most recent changes:** This column displays the most recent value for the property/field if a User has submitted additional changes **after** this Place Correction Task was created. If no additional changes have been submitted since the Task was created, the column will simply display "No additional changes submitted". If an additional change has been submitted for the Place, this field will show the value of the most recent change, even if that change is still pending moderation. This field will ALWAYS match what is live on the website.

If you see that there are additional changes, it is very likely that there are also additional Tasks for this Place. These Tasks are listed at the bottom of the Task page.

It is important to consider the most recent additional changes as new information may influence your decision to Apply or Discard the Corrections.

3. In the Property Column, if you see 'Description' or 'Open for Business', you should consider the following:

Descriptions:

- Most description corrections are minor. Users are just making the description more accurate, updating prices. These corrections can be Accepted quickly.
- Watch out for description edits that say a Place is Closed or the Place could not be found. If you see this type of comment in a description, make sure that the "Open for Business" field is set to 'No'. Users sometimes leave a note in the description field, but they fail to mark the Place closed.

Open for Business = No (See the screenshot below):

When you see that the Open for Business property is changed to 'No', the Place has been marked Closed. See the screenshot below for an example of how this will appear.

Review these proposed changes:

If there are additional changes in the Current Value column, subsequent edits have occurred after this task was created. Check for other open tasks for this place at the bottom of the page.

Property	Old Value	Proposed Value	Current Value with most recent changes
open_for_business	open_yes	open_no	No additional changes submitted.

IMPORTANT! Most closed places should be flagged for deletion. Only Moderators can take this action. Users are not able to flag for deletion. Full details on when to Flag for Deletion are in this [previous Section](#).

For every Place correction where the Place has been Closed:

- 1) Read through the proposed changes, the Place description and the last five Check-ins. If camping is clearly illegal, the place should be Flagged for Deletion and possibly changed to an Overnight Prohibited pin. Again, [see our rules here](#).
- 2) If you decide that the Place should be flagged for deletion, click the checkbox for “Flag for Deletion” in the editable boxes under the Table of Proposed Changes (see the screenshot below). Make sure you add a [Moderator Note](#), indicating why the place was deleted.

4. Scrolling further down the page, you will see a set of boxes with all the descriptive fields and amenities of the Place. You can edit any of the text in the boxes.

Current place details: To save edits to these fields, you must apply corrections.

Place category	Established Campground	Country	Namibia		
Date verified	2020 June 2	Name	Windpomp 14		
Description	Flag for Deletion: ☐				
There are 21 big sandy sites with their own private ablution. Inside is a toilet, small kitchen with big fridge/freezer, a one pit burner stove, sink and shower area with sink. Outside a fireplace for braai and covered seating area. In the bag is a sink for washing with a wash-line as well. The site is build in 3 rows. Site 1-7 (N230 pppn) with sea view, 8-14 (N200 pppn) in the middle and 15-21 (180 pppn) furthest away from the sea.					
Source url	Open for business	Electricity	Internet	Kitchen	Restaurant
Windpomp14.com	Yes	Yes - At Sites	No	Yes	Yes
Showers	Water	Restroom	Big rig friendly	Tent friendly	Pet friendly
Hot	Non-Potable	Running Water	Yes	Yes	Yes

-
- You do not need to review each of these boxes! If you have reviewed the Table of Corrections and agree with the proposed corrections, skip this section.
 - **If you make changes to any of these boxes, you must click the green Apply Corrections button at the bottom of the Task page. If you click Discard Corrections any changes you make will be lost.**
 - These boxes will always show the most recent values for each field, even if there are still corrections pending moderation.

- If you make edits in these boxes, your edits will override any corrections listed in the Table of Proposed Changes. Your edits will also override any additional corrections submitted by Users that may still be pending moderation.
- Remember that if you flag a place for deletion you should add a Moderator Note to the description, explaining why this was done.

5. Moving further down the Task page, we see a list of the five most recent Check-ins for this Place.

5 Most Recent Check-Ins:

- [troopyblog.wordpress.com](#) on June 2nd, 2020: Great place to stay on the beach for a couple of days. Big sites with private ablution. See description for all details.
- [guzzleh2o.com](#) on March 14th, 2020: This was a great pit stop on our way north. The ablutions were new and private to each site. There was a small kitchen with a refrigerator inside as well. Right near the ocean with different pricing for how close you stay. The restaurant looked nice too.
- [a3discoverstheplanet.com](#) on January 14th, 2020: Cheapest option in December & January 230 ppn. (Feb till Nov 180 ppn) Actual name camping is millpump 14, also a restaurant/bar. Looks nice. We liked the private ablutions including 'kitchen'.
- [michalucko](#) on September 25th, 2019: No more shared ablutions, only sites with private one, the price changes between the row according to the distance from the sea, the far ones (third row) cost 180N\$ pp. Water are drinkable
- [g.pillonel](#) on June 29th, 2019: There is no budget camping anymore. The official price is now 230N\$ ppn but negotiable. 1st class private ablution and kitchen block. It was so clean that I even slept inside.

Sometimes, when reviewing the Table of Proposed Changes, you may wonder if the submitter made an error. You can review recent Check-ins to see if other Users have reported similar problems.

This is particularly useful for Places that are marked closed. Sometimes Users report Places closed because they cannot find the Place. However, perhaps the Place isn't actually closed: the User was simply lost! If a Place is popular (as evidenced by several Check-ins), and for seemingly no reason one User reports they cannot find the Place, the proposed correction is usually a mistake. Discard these corrections! A Check-in will remain that says "I could not find the place" to warn future travelers, but the Place should remain open!

6. The choices at the bottom of the Task page are:

Apply Corrections

Discard Corrections

- If the corrections are legitimate, click the "Apply Corrections" button.
- If you decide that the corrections should not be accepted, click the "Discard Corrections" button.

After clicking Apply or Discard, the next Task in your My Tasks List will automatically load. You will see a green bar at the top of the Task page that indicates "New task ready".

7. At the very bottom of the Task page, you will see a section for 'Other open tasks for this place':

Other open tasks for this place:

☐ Task	Task ID	User	Priority	Status	Description
☐ Place Corrections	140418	Unknown	5	unassigned	Mile 14 Camping

Assign to User

Note: clicking the Assign to User button will refresh this page, and you will lose any changes entered. Make note of your changes before reassigning these tasks

-
- Most of the time, this section can be ignored (that is why it's at the very bottom!) However, if you have noticed additional corrections in the "Current Value" column in the Table of Proposed Changes, you will need to check this table.
 - Occasionally a User or Owner will submit multiple corrections for a Place. This situation creates multiple Place correction Tasks and it is easiest if one Moderator completes all of them. We recommend these steps:
 - Reassign these Tasks to yourself, by checking the box next to the Task. Select your name in the drop-down list, and click "Assign to User". The Task page will refresh, and this table will be updated.
 - Then hold CTRL and click on the Task name and open each of these Tasks in a new tab.
 - You will need to complete each Task in sequence, starting with the oldest. Use the Task ID numbers to help. In general, the first tab opened will be the newest Task and should be completed last! You will know you are dealing with the newest proposed correction, because the "Current Value" in the table will say "No additional changes submitted"

Other Helpful Advice

Trivial Tasks

Place Correction Tasks that only involve changing amenities (like wifi speed, showers, bathrooms, etc) are called Trivial Tasks. Trivial Tasks should be closed before you assign yourself new Tasks. (See Part 3.) Place Correction Tasks are only for moderating changes to the following fields: Name of Place, Category, Description, Location and whether the Place is Open/Closed.

Part 7: Place Issue Tasks (Task Type 4)

The Task type, "Place Issues", deals with User-reported problems. Tasks of this type are generated when a User clicks the Report a Problem button and then submits a comment or instructions for a Moderator. Most User-reported items simply create normal Tasks (like a Place Correction Task or Eliminate Duplicate Task). However, Place Issues are special because the User leaves a comment. These comments must be reviewed by a real human (that's you!) and addressed accordingly. For more details on how the Report a Problem button works, see the Appendix.

Basic Steps for Place Issue Tasks

These are the basic steps to completing Place Issue Tasks.

1. Make sure you are logged on to iOverlander and navigate to your [My Tasks list](#).
2. Click on the name of the Task, "Place Issue", to open the Task.
3. Review the Type of Issue and the User's comments and determine the best action. Usually, a simple correction needs to be made to the Place details. Sometimes, an Issue should simply be ignored (eg a User is complaining about the price of a Place!).
4. Make any edits to the Place, if needed.
5. Add Moderator Notes to the Place description or email the User, if required.
6. Click on 'Update Place'.

Place Issue Task Page

A typical Task page for a Place Issue Task might look like the screenshot shown below. (We're only showing the top of the page to begin.)



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Task type: Place Issue

User: Jessica Mans

Priority: 3

Task Status: assigned

Linked Issues:

Date Reported	Reported By	Issue Status	Reference Task ID	Issue Type	User Comment	Contact User
2020-06-06	hello	open	140361	Other	You are no longer allowed to park in here. They sent someone from Walmart around midnight and were told the police would be around giving tickets later...too bad	Contact User

Place Issue for: [Carson City Walmart](#)

Type of issue: [Other](#)

User comment: You are no longer allowed to park in here. They sent someone from Walmart around midnight and were told the police would be around giving tickets later...too bad

-
1. The top gray bar will show you the Task type, the User to whom the Task is assigned, the Task priority and the Task status.
 2. Just under the gray bar, you will see a section for Linked Issues. Remember that Issues are User-Reported Problems. You will **always** see a Linked Issue in a Place Issue Task type and you can always ignore it. The Issue will be closed when the Task is completed.
 3. In our example, the Place name is 'Carson City Walmart'. Just like other Task types, if you click on this name, the Place Detail page will open. You normally do not need to view a Place Detail page, but occasionally it is necessary to make changes that are not possible within the Task page. (See Part 3 for details.)
 4. **Type of Issue:** This field will tell you the type of Issue that was reported. There are only two options: 'Place is in the wrong location' OR 'Other'. We will explain these two types in detail below.
 5. **User Comment:** This field contains the comment that the User entered to explain their Issue. You will need to read this comment carefully to understand the problem that is being reported.
 6. Scrolling further down the Task page, you will see a set of boxes with all the fields and amenities of the Place. You can edit any of the text in the boxes. You do not need to review each of these boxes unless the User-Reported Issue requires you to do so.

Current place details, edit if needed:

Place category	Informal Campsite	Country	United States
Date verified	2020 February 13	Name	Carson City Walmart
Description		Flag for Deletion: ☐	
ADMIN NOTE: No overnight camping allowed, please respect the wishes of the locals.			
Source url		Open for business	No
Internet	No	Kitchen	No
Showers	No	Water	Yes
Big rig friendly	No	Tent friendly	No
Electricity	No	Restaurant	Yes
		Restroom	Running Water
		Pet friendly	No

Update Place

After reviewing the Issue Type and the User's Comment, you should determine if you need to make any edits to these fields before closing the Task. Here are suggestions based on the two different Issue Types:

Issue Type: Place is in the wrong location

Users often report Issues for Places that are in the wrong location, but sometimes they don't know the correct location. Occasionally the User has a street address, but no GPS coordinates. Or sometimes, the User knows a Place location isn't right, but does not have any further details. To resolve this type of Issue, read the User comment and make edits to the Place as necessary.

A few common scenarios are:

- The User does not give any information about the location of the Place. In this case, you will mark the Place as 'closed', by changing Open for Business to No. And you should include a [Moderator Note](#) at the top of the description with text similar to the following:

"MODERATOR NOTE: User reports location is incorrect. Place closed."

The User states that the Place is in a slightly different location, but the User does not provide coordinates. If this happens, paste the User's comment at the very top of the description, but leave the Place open.

Issue Type: Other

Issues in the 'Other' category are the most time-consuming Tasks to complete. There are many different errors reported using the "Other" option. This category becomes a catchall for any type of problem a User could not resolve themselves. As you might imagine it receives all types of interesting complaints and concerns. There are far too many possibilities to cover here, and most of the time

Moderators can resolve these issues with a little bit of common sense. Here are two common situations:

- A Place is reported as illegal or closed. In this case, you need to close the Place (change the 'open for business' field to 'No') or flag for deletion (see the checkbox in the screenshot above). Depending on the User comment, you'll need to decide the best action.
- Sometimes comments in this field should actually be Check-ins. In this case, you can use the handy Convert to Check-in button located only on this issue type. You'll need to first click "Convert to Checkin". The task will then reload, and you can continue to make edits or close as needed:

Convert to Check-In

User: jessica@jessicamans.com

Check-Ins: [Life Remotely](#)

I was at this place and they don't have free beer anymore.

Convert to Check-In

7. At the bottom of the Task page you will see the following:

Update Place

Other open tasks for this place:

There are no other open tasks for this place.

[My Open Tasks](#) | [Edit](#) | [Back](#)

- After you have addressed the User's comment, click "Update Place". This will close the Task, and the linked Issue.
- If the Issue is not valid or does not require any action on your part, and if you do not make any changes, simply click the button "Update Place" anyway. This will close out the Task, and the Issue, without making any edits.

8. Other Open Tasks

- Occasionally, multiple Users will report Issues for a Place, which creates multiple Place Issue Tasks. It is easiest if one Moderator completes all Tasks related to a Place. You can see a list of any other open Tasks in the table under the green Update Place button. In the example shown above, there were no other open Tasks.
- If there are other open Tasks, you will see something similar to this:

Other open tasks for this place:

☐ Task	Task ID	User	Priority	Status	Description
☐ Place Corrections	140418	Unknown	5	unassigned	Mile 14 Camping

Note: clicking the Assign to User button will refresh this page, and you will lose any changes entered. Make note of your changes before reassigning these tasks.

You should reassign these Tasks to yourself. Simply check the box next to the Task name, select your name in the drop-down list, and click “Assign to User”. The page will refresh, and the table will be updated. In the example above, the Task type is a Place Correction but other Task types could be listed as well. It is best to review and complete all of the Tasks for this place at one time.

Part 7: Flagged Check-in Tasks (Task Type 5)

The Task type, "Flagged Check-in" deals with three problems:

1. User-reported problems with Check-ins
2. User-reported problems with images, and
3. Check-ins that have been flagged automatically because they contain a keyword.

The first two create tasks when a User clicks the Report Check-in or Flag Image button and then submits a comment. These comments must be reviewed by a Moderator and addressed accordingly. The third instance creates a flagged check-in task if a check-in contains a specific keyword. These keywords help to find profanity, malicious posts, wifi passwords, and illegal camp spots. They need to be reviewed and addressed appropriately.

Basic Steps for Flagged Check-in Tasks

These are the basic steps to completing Flagged Checkin Tasks.

1. Make sure you are logged on to iOverlander and navigate to your My Tasks list.
(http://ioverlander.com/tasks/my_open_tasks)
2. Click on the name of the Task, "Flagged Checkin", to open the Task.
3. Review the User's comments or the Flagged Keyword, and determine the best action. Usually, a simple correction or deletion needs to be made to the checkin or image. Sometimes, an Issue should simply be ignored (eg an owner complaining about a bad review!).
4. Make any edits to the Place, if needed.
5. Click on 'Update Check-in'.

Flagged Check-in Task Page

A typical Task page for a Flagged Check-in Task might look like the screenshot shown below. (We're only showing the top of the page to begin.)



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Task type: Flagged Check-In

User: Jessica Mans

Priority: 1

Task Status: assigned

Linked Issues

Date Reported	Reported By	Issue Status	Reference Task ID	Issue Type	User Comment	Contact User
2021-08-31	Life Remotely	open	157983	Flagged Check-In	This checkin in for the wrong place. Please can you delete it for me.	Contact User

Flagged Check-In for [Backpacker's Paradise](#)

Check-In Submitted By: [timeoutdoors](#)

Check-In Date: November 30th, 2019

Reporter Comment:

This checkin in for the wrong place. Please can you delete it for me.

Check-In Comment:

We were very disappointed! First, the campground is not at the beach as the photos on here might indicate. we didnt stay the night but asked for a shower. The french owner wasn't there but the nice girl at the place called her. She said the day use fee would be 10 belize dollars per person. We thought it's pricey but if you need a

The top gray bar will show you the Task type, the User to whom the Task is assigned, the Task priority and the Task status. Most of the time, these fields will not change (e.g. you will always be the User and the Task status will be 'assigned').

1. Just under the gray bar, you will see a section for Linked Issues. Remember that Issues are User-Reported Problems. You will **always** see a Linked Issue in a Flagged Check-in Task type and you can always ignore it. The Issue will be closed when the Task is completed.
2. In our example, the Place name is 'Backpacker's Paradise. Just like other Task types, if you click on this name, the Place Detail page will open. You normally do not need to view a Place Detail page.
3. **Reporter Comment:** (User reported) This field contains the comment that the User entered to explain their Issue. You will need to read this comment carefully to understand the problem that is being reported. Sometimes the comment will refer to an image. In this case, scroll to the bottom of the page to see images associated with the check-in.

Reporter Comment: (Keyword flag) If this is a flagged check-in because of a keyword it contains, the reporter comment will tell you what word was found. For example:

Reporter Comment:

Comment on check in contained a word from the Profanity & Offensive language list: 'Shitty'

4. **Check-in Comment:** This is an editable field which shows the check-in which was reported. You can use this to make updates to the check-in, such as removing profanity, wifi passwords, etc.

TIP:

iOverlander's policy on profanity and inappropriate language is explained in detail in Part 2. As a reminder, if it's fun and cheeky, just replace the bad words. If it's malicious and angry, delete the entire check-in and replace with the note: Moderator Note: "Comments removed because of inappropriate content."

5. Scrolling further down the Task page, you will see a set of boxes with all the fields and amenities of the Place. You can edit any of the text in the boxes. These editable boxes exist ONLY to make it easy for you to edit the Place, if needed. You do not need to review each of these boxes unless the User-Reported Issue requires you to do so.

Place category	Established Campground ▾	Country	Belize ▾
Date verified	2021 ▾ July ▾ 23 ▾	Name	Backpacker's Paradise
Description Excellent mosquito-screened common area with tables, hammocks, power and a kitchen. Super friendly owners. Wifi in the restaurant and common areas. There is a dedicated modem in the common area/kitchen. Horses roam around free on the campground, its a unique experience to connect with those awesome animals.test aminity change			
Latitude:	18.3448	Longitude:	-88.15288
Place Website	http://backpackers.blueg	Open for business	Yes ▾
Internet	Yes - Average ▾	Kitchen	No ▾
Showers	Warm ▾	Water	Non-Potable ▾
Big rig friendly	Yes ▾	Tent friendly	Yes ▾
Phone		Sanitation dump	Unknown ▾
Electricity	Yes - At Sites ▾	Restaurant	No ▾
		Restroom	Running Water ▾
		Pet friendly	Yes ▾

Photos:

Check-In does not have photos

6. At the bottom of the Task page you will see the following buttons:



Contact User

Other open tasks for this place:

There are no other open tasks for this place.

- **Update Check-in:** If you have made edits to the check-in, place or images, click this green button. It will record your edits and close the Task.
- **Dismiss Issue:** If the Issue is not valid or does not require any action on your part, and you do not make any changes, simply click the button “Dismiss Issue”. This will close out the Task without making any edits.
- **Destroy Check-in:** If the entire check-in needs to be destroyed, you can click this button. This cannot be undone.

NOTE: A full list of the keywords that are flagged is listed here:

https://ioverlander.com/admin/bad_keywords

If you have a suggestion for words to add or remove, contact your coach. We are constantly updating this list to flag the most relevant check-ins.

Part 9: Bulk Image Moderation

Most images submitted to iOverlander are moderated as part of New Place Approval Tasks. However, Users are also able to submit images with check-ins. We do not moderate all Check-ins, because we receive so many of them. Instead, images submitted through these check-ins are bulk moderated, meaning that 100 image thumbnails are grouped together on a single page for review. This is much faster than requiring a separate task for each Image.

Because Images are moderated in bulk, they do not have “assignable” tasks associated with them. If you are interested in image moderation, contact your coach.

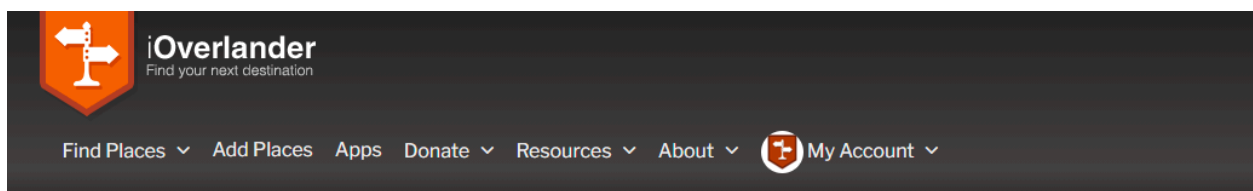
Basic Steps for Bulk Image Moderation

These are the basic steps to completing Bulk Image Moderation.

1. Make sure you are logged on to iOverlander and navigate to the image moderation page: <https://ioverlander.com/images/moderate>
2. Review each thumbnail image on the page. Rotate images by clicking the degree buttons under the thumbnail. And click on the image if you need to view in detail or read the accompanying Check-in text.
3. Click DELETE IMAGE under any images that do not meet criteria and need to be removed.
4. Once all images on the page have been reviewed, click “MARK AS MODERATED” at the bottom of the page.
5. A new page of images will load. Review this page in the same style.

Bulk Image Moderation Page

A typical bulk image moderation page looks like this:



Listing images

-
1. Each page contains 100 images that will need to be reviewed. The following are common adjustments to make:
 - Sideways or upside-down images need to be rotated.
 - Duplicate photos need to be deleted.
 - Images which do not meet guidelines need to be destroyed (see image guidelines in [Part 2](#))
 2. Here are some basic instructions on how to make these adjustments:

Deleting Images:

If an image is a duplicate or does not meet criteria you can delete it by clicking the blue delete link under the image. However, it is often best to open the Image Detail Page (by clicking on the thumbnail) and review closely before deleting, as this action cannot be undone!

Rotating images:

If an image needs to be rotated, click the button under the image for the degrees to rotate it. -90 for counter-clockwise, 90 for clockwise, and 180 to turn upside-down. Note that the rotation will NOT appear on this thumbnail page. However, after clicking a rotate button, the Image Detail page will load in a new tab. You don't need to do any further editing, but if you wish to review the rotating, this page will provide that option. Images in this new tab will initially show up broken, because reprocessing is underway. After a few seconds, refresh the page to see your changes.

Corrupt or mis-processed images:

If an image is missing or appears corrupted, for example:



Open the Image Detail Page by clicking on the thumbnail. Scroll down to the bottom of the page and look for the Source Image. If the source image does not exist, then the original image is corrupt and it should be deleted. If the source image looks fine, scroll back up to the top of the page and click the Reprocess button. After a few seconds refresh the page and the issue should be fixed.

3. **Reviewing Checkins & Image Source**

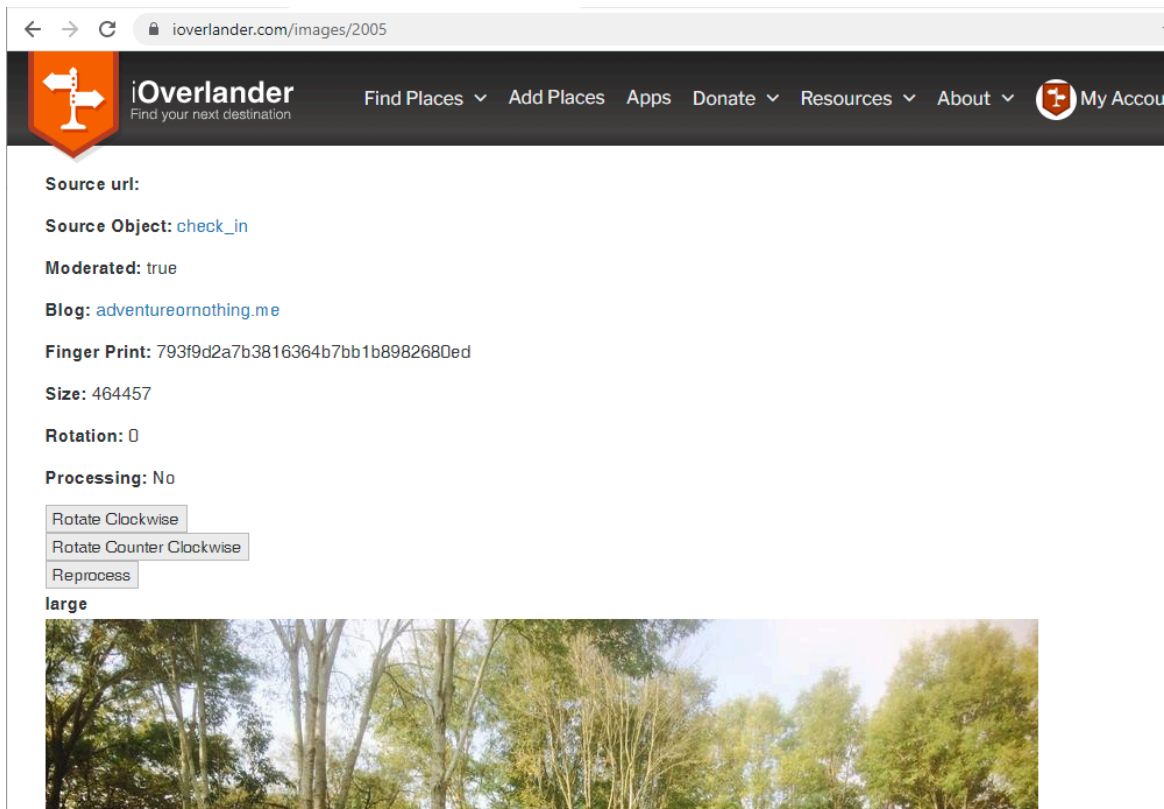
In most cases the thumbnail is more than sufficient to determine if the image meets criteria. However there are a few instances where you may need to view more details.

IMPORTANT:

The bulk image moderation shows images from New Places and Check-ins, but it also shows Users Vehicle Images. It's important to make sure that when you delete an image it is NOT a Users profile or Vehicle picture.

To determine the source of an image and read the accompanying check-in text, follow these steps:

- a. From the bulk image moderation page, click on the image thumbnail. A new tab will load with the Image Detail page. This is an example:



At the top of the page you will notice the words "Source Object". It will say one of two things:

- **Check-in:** This means the image was submitted with a User Check-in or a New Place. You can click on the text to be redirected to the Check-in. This is useful for obscure images that may have relevance that's not obvious without the accompanying comments.
- **Vehicle:** This image was submitted as part of a User's personal Garage. These images should NOT be deleted unless they are malicious or inappropriate.

Also on the Image Detail Page you will see the following:

- **Moderated:** This will tell you if this image has been moderated or not. When bulk moderating, this will be set to false.
- **Blog:** This is a link to the blog of the user who submitted the image.
- **Rotation:** Tells you if the image has a rotation applied.
- **Reprocessing:** Tells you if the server is currently working to reprocess the image sizes. (When this says Yes, you may not be able to see the image thumbnails correctly. Reprocessing only take a minute, just refresh the page if this happens.)
- **Rotate Buttons:** These buttons will rotate the image. Note that you will have to wait for the image to reprocess after rotating.
- **Reprocess Button:** You can use the button to manually reprocess an image. This is required if the source image looks ok, but the thumbnail or other sizes are corrupt or don't exist.

Use the information on this Image Details page to make better judgements regarding images. Oftentimes an obscure image will be relevant once you read what the user has to say in their check-in. After reviewing the details of the image or check-in, simply close the tab and return to the main Image Moderation page.

4. Once you have reviewed all images on the page and made necessary adjustments, be sure to click the Mark all As Moderated button on the bottom of the page.

Mark All As Moderated

Clicking this button changes all images from Moderated: False to Moderated: True, and removes them from the bulk moderation queue.

5. If there are more images to moderate a new page of images will load.

Appendix: Additional Procedures

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Review Past Tasks for a Place
Review History for a Place
Manually Closing and Deleting/Undeleting Places
User Search
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Place Issues and the Report a Problem Button

Review Past Tasks for a Place

In some instances, you may want to look up past Tasks that have been completed for a Place. This usually happens when you need to investigate past changes. For example, you may wish to determine why a Place was closed or why/who changed a description.

1. Visit the Place detail page: for example, <http://ioverlander.com/places/66125-difficult-road>
2. Add "/tasks" to the end of the URL: for example, <http://ioverlander.com/places/66125-difficult-road/tasks>

The resulting page will show you all Tasks associated with the Place. Note that the Tasks are sorted by priority, not by the date of the Task.

Review History for a Place

If you need to see previous versions of a Place (for example, you may want to see what a Place looked like before corrections were implemented) you can view the Place history. This procedure is not commonly used, but sometimes when you need to dig deeper into why a Place detail has been changed, a Place's history can provide essential clues.

1. Visit the Place detail page: for example, <http://ioverlander.com/places/66125-difficult-road>

2. Add "/history" to the end of the URL: for example,
<http://ioverlander.com/places/66125-difficult-road/history>

The resulting page will show you all past versions of a Place.

Manually Closing and Deleting/Undeleting Places

When you decide that a Place should be rejected, the Place will be flagged for deletion automatically. However, there are occasions when you will need to manually close a Place or Flag for Deletion. In addition, sometimes you may need to Undelete a Place. For example, you may initially choose to reject a Place that is missing important information and concurrently, you may also send the User an email to ask for clarification. If the User replies and provides the missing information, you will need to return to the Place Detail page and manually undelete the Place. The procedures are described below.

Closing Places Manually:

1. To manually close a place, load the Place Detail page. For example:
<http://ioverlander.com/places/1-backpacker-s-paradise>
8. At the very bottom of the Place Detail page, click the "Edit" button.

[Edit](#) | [Flag Deleted](#) | [Issue](#)

9. On the edit page, change the Open field to 'No'.

Open	Yes ▼
Last Visited	Unknown Yes No

10. Click Submit at the bottom of the page.



Flag for Deletion:

There are many situations when a Place must be 'flagged for deletion' which is an action that can only be undertaken by Moderators. For example, any Place that does not meet our Criteria for New Places must be flagged for deletion. Sometimes a Place is in the wrong location, or it's illegal or spam, and this Place must be rejected (which results in flagging for deletion). Also, any Place that has only one Check-in and was subsequently Closed should be flagged for deletion. These examples have all been described in previous parts of the Moderator Guide.

1. To flag a Place for deletion, load a Place Detail page.
2. At the bottom of the page, click on the link "Flag Deleted".



3. A popup will appear asking if you are sure. Click Ok.

Don't forget to add a [Moderator Note](#) to the Place, to explain why you are flagging for deletion!

Undeleting a Place:

1. Go to the deleted Place's detail page.
11. At the bottom of the page, click "Undelete"



User Search

If you need to locate a User in our database you can do a search based on the User's email address on this page: <https://ioverlander.com/admin/users>

The page will show any Users whose email address matched the address you have entered.

User Search

E-mail:

Username	Registered	Role	Blog	
Generic User Acct	2018-01-22	Moderator	Traveler199	Edit Delete user

Clicking on the blue-colored Username, will bring up the User's details. Clicking on the blue-colored link under Blog will bring up the User's Blog details.

Note that User email addresses are available to Administrators and Moderators, but not to other Users. Please respect our User's privacy and do not share email addresses without permission of the User.

Quick Editor

Normally you will be working with the standard view of Task pages. However, sometimes it is faster to use the Quick Editor view which shows multiple Tasks on the same page. You can access your Tasks in Quick Editor mode using the following link: http://ioverlander.com/tasks/my_open_tasks_quick_edit

The Quick Editor shows the basic information for each Place but excludes some of the finer details. For example, you won't see amenities and you won't see editable fields or a large map. Some easy Tasks can be quickly completed in the Quick Editor view. Also, using this view saves time as you do not have to wait for each individual Task to load on a separate page.

Each Task in the Quick Editor view has options to complete the Task immediately, or to view full details. If you click 'full details', the full screen view of the Task will be loaded and you can complete the Task as you would in the standard view.

We recommend using the Quick Editor ONLY for Place Correction Tasks! Most of the time, insufficient information is provided in this view and it is not suitable for making careful decisions. Do NOT use Quick Editor when completing New Place Approval Tasks, Duplicate Place Tasks, or Place Issue Tasks as the Quick Editor view does not show enough information to moderate properly.

Moving a Check-in

Sometimes it is necessary to move a Check-in from one Place to another Place. This occurs mostly when a Place falls into multiple categories, and you need to split one Place into multiple Places and move Check-ins accordingly. This is how it's done:

1. First, you need to know the Place ID where the Check-in is going to be moved to. This ID is found in the URL of the Place. For example, this Place has an ID of 7307:
<http://ioverlander.com/places/7307-wild-oats-farmer-s-market>
2. Next, go to the Place detail page of the Place which currently contains the Check-in which needs to be moved.
3. In the column on the right side, you will see a list of all the Check-ins for that Place. Click on the date of the Check-in that you want to move. This action will open the Check-in detail page.

Latest Check-Ins

December 10th, 2019 by Olivier 

Contact User

hello, we spent three days at the campsite.
the horses are beautiful and the dogs are
nice. we washed our vehicle on site to go to
the islands. Nathalie very nice, she gave us
all the info.

-
4. Click on the Edit link at the bottom of the Check-in detail page.

[Edit](#) | [Back](#)

5. The 'Editing Check-In' page opens. You can now simply replace the number in the field under 'Place' with the ID of the Place where you want the Check-in to move. This is the number you located in step 1 above.

Place

7307

6. Click on the 'Save' button at the bottom of the page.
-

2015

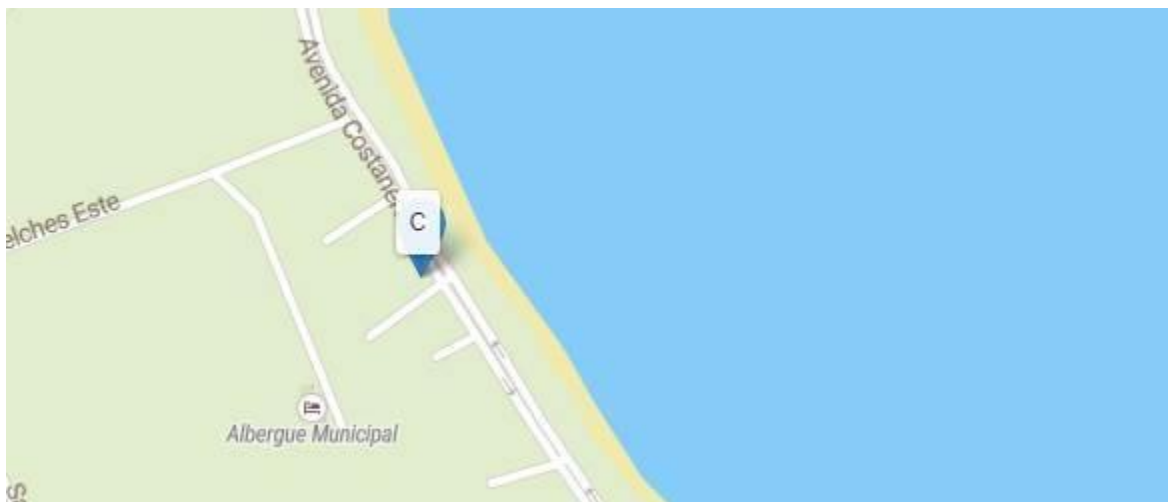
Save

Show | Ba

Finding Duplicates

Very rarely, you may be completing a Task, and you suspect that the Place may be a duplicate of another Place. To check for duplicates in nearby Places, do the following:

1. From within the Task page, click on the pin on the map. (The pin usually has the letter 'C' on it.)
-





If you happen to find a Place that is a duplicate of another Place, the best action is to report the situation as an "Issue", according to the instructions below. After you have reported the Issue, an Eliminate Duplicates Task will be created which you (or another Moderator) can complete.

1. Go to the Place detail page of one of the duplicates.
2. Click the 'Report a Problem' button.
3. Click "This place is a duplicate".
4. Select the duplicate Place from the drop-down menu and click "Report Duplicate".

5. This will create an Eliminate Duplicate Task for another Moderator to review.
6. You can go to the Unassigned Task list and complete the Task yourself if time permits.

Automated email text

This is the email sent when CHANGES are made to places which are accepted:

Hi *[username]*:

Thank you for your recent submission to iOverlander: *[Name of place with LINK]*

We want you to know that your place was **changed** for the following reasons:

[Reason 1 here]

[Reason 2 here]

In addition, the moderator would like you to know:

[Custom moderator comment]

Please understand that our moderators are all volunteers and in order to keep our database relevant to overlanders and our apps free, we occasionally need to make these edits. You can read our general and category specific criteria on our website or in the Help Center on the app.

If you have additional questions, please reply to this email, it will be automatically routed to the volunteer moderator that reviewed your place.

Sincerely,

[Moderator name]

iOverlander Moderator

The email for REJECTED places reads:

Hi *[username]*:

Thank you for your recent submission to iOverlander: *[Name of place with LINK]*

We want you to know that your place was **not accepted** for the following reasons:

[Reason 1 here]

[Reason 2 here]

In addition, the moderator would like you to know:

[Custom moderator comment]

We are sorry for this inconvenience and really hate it when travelers take time to add new places and we can't accept them! We send this email in hopes of educating our users so their time is not wasted, and if possible fix the problem and publish your place!

Please understand that our moderators are all volunteers, and in order to keep our database relevant to overlanders, we have to place criteria on what entries we accept. You can read our General and Category Specific criteria in the Help Center of the app, or on our website under Resources.

If you have additional questions, please reply to this email, it will be automatically routed to the volunteer moderator that reviewed your place.

Sincerely,
[Moderator name]
iOverlander Moderator

These are the reasons added based on the checkboxes:

The text on the left shows what is displayed on the task page next to the checkbox. The text in the right column shows what is inserted into the email. PLEASE READ through these, so you know what is being sent to your users!

For CHANGES:

Category Changed	The category you have selected seems to be incorrect. We have updated your place category. You can review the new category by clicking the link above. You can read all categories and definitions on our website: https://ioverlander.com/legend
Translated to English	Your place description was translated to English. We have left your original text and added a new translation. Please enter your places in English if possible, if not, please continue entering in your preferred language and a moderator will translate for you. We apologize, you may receive this email notification for other places added, please ignore them.
Delete wifi password	We removed the wifi password entered in your place description. Wifi passwords are not permitted on iOverlander. We know these passwords are helpful to travelers, but please understand that we receive many requests from establishments to remove them, so their wifi can remain secure.
Removed personal website	We have removed your personal website or social media handle from the place description. You can update the link to your personal website in your Profile settings on iOverlander.com. Go to My Account then My Profile. This will automatically give you credit and a link to your website on every place you add.
Restaurant - Average quality, warning to improve	We believe your entry is valuable and have not changed or removed it, but wanted to ask that you add more information to this and future restaurant places. These are common areas for improvement: 1. Make sure you mention the food! What type of cuisine is served, what are the menu options, what are the specialty items, etc. 2. Mention available parking, wifi speed, ambiance. 3. Tell us the cost and serving size, is this a good value? 4. Add photos of the menu, food, building, etc.

Other - Enter custom message below	Please see the moderator comments below.
------------------------------------	--

For REJECTIONS:

Wrong Location	Your place appears to be in the wrong location. If you have the correct coordinates, please reply to this email. The moderator who reviewed your place will update and publish it for you.
Illegal camping	It appears that camping is not permitted at the location you submitted. iOverlander does not allow any points where camping is prohibited, either by laws, property regulations, or environmental harm. If you added a place on private property, you must explicitly state that you were given permission (and by whom). If you believe camping is permitted, please reply to this email and let the moderator know.
Temporary Place	It appears that this is a temporary place. Because many overlanders download our database for offline use, we do not allow temporary places, as they are often gone before travelers arrive. If you believe this place is permanent, please reply to this email and let the moderator know.
Road Report	This place appears to be a basic road report. We have a very hard time with road reports in our database, because road conditions change so often, and vary so much depending on the travelers opinions. We realize that information about new roads and bridges is extremely valuable for overlanders, but tools like OpenStreetMap (OSM) are much better designed to provide this information. We are hoping to add a new category for these reports in the future, but in the meantime, we encourage you to add your point to OSM instead. Basic instructions can be found here: http://ioverlander.com/osm
Description poor quality	Your place has not been approved because the description does not contain sufficient information. If you would like to resubmit with more detail, please reply to this email with additional information about the place. We value good, detailed descriptions in iOverlander. Please note that we receive many very brief and vague descriptions, and facts which may seem obvious to one traveler may not seem obvious to another, or to a moderator. If there is something unusual about your place or its location which warrants a brief description, please reply and let the moderator know.
Inappropriate Content	Your place has not been approved because it contains inappropriate content.
Missing critical information	Your place has not been approved because it is missing critical information. If you have this information or are unsure what information is needed, please reply to this email with the details. The moderator who reviewed your submission can update and publish your place.
Did not investigate / stay the night	Your place has not been approved because it does not appear that it has been thoroughly investigated, or in the case of wild camping, because you did not stay the night. iOverlander requires that all places be visited by a traveler, who thoroughly investigates the place. We do not accept these places, nor do we bulk import points, because it frequently leads to incorrect or incomplete information, particularly about

	wild camping permissions. If you have additional information, or did stay the night, please reply to this email and let the moderator know.
Restaurant - Poor Description	Because of the prevalence of very poor restaurants on iOverlander we are taking many steps to improve this category for all travelers. One step is to strictly apply our criteria which requires that 1. The description of the restaurant must be detailed and good quality, 2. The restaurant must have exceptionally good food, prices, or location, unless it's in a very remote area. Consider mentioning available parking, wifi, ambiance, if the restaurant is in a remote area or serving specialty items. Be sure your description of the restaurant is detailed, don't forget to tell us about the cuisine and add photos. Please don't be discouraged, we love restaurants and we really want you to resubmit!
Other - Does not meet criteria	Your place has not been approved because it does not meet iOverlander criteria. For details, please see our General and Category Specific criteria in the Help Center of the app, or on our website under Resources.

Understanding Issues and the Report a Problem Button

What is an Issue?

Issues are different from Tasks. Tasks are automatically generated while Issues are created by Users when they click the Report a Problem (RAP) button. The RAP button is located on every Place Detail page.

There are five different types of Issues that Users can report using the RAP button.

What is the issue with test place.

- [This place is closed or doesn't exist](#)
 - [This place is in the wrong location](#)
 - [This place is a duplicate](#)
 - [The details, description or amenities are wrong](#)
 - [Something else...](#)
-

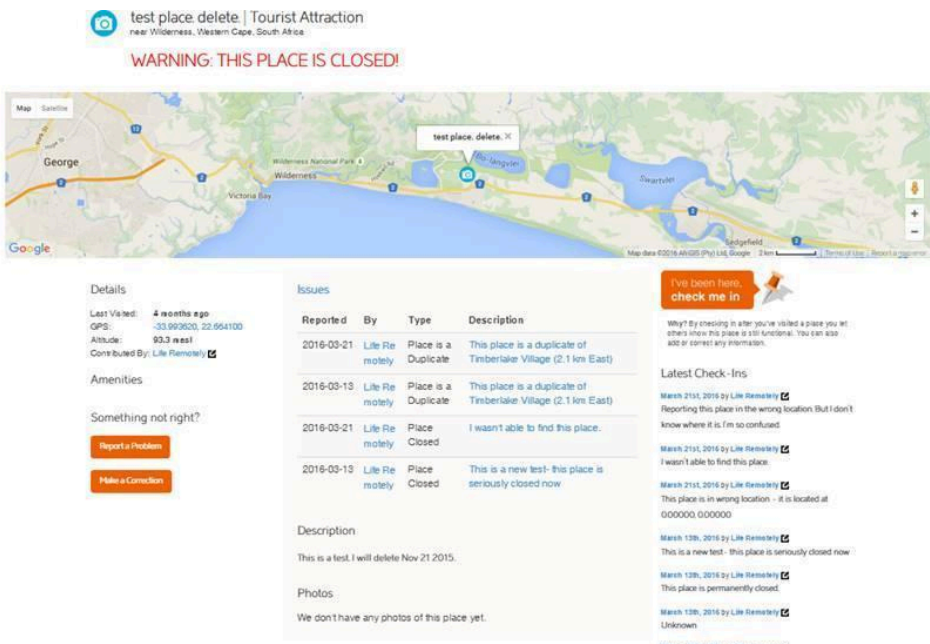
Some of the above Issues are problems that Users could resolve themselves with a Check-in, but many Users don't understand how a Check-in works, so we have added this second option to Report a Problem. For example, many people email us and ask "how do I mark a place closed?" This is something a User can do with a Check-in, but the Issue can also be handled by clicking the RAP button.

When an Issue is reported by a User, the iOverlander system creates both an Issue and a Task. The Task is generated so that a Moderator will be able to resolve the Issue. The Task page looks exactly the same as other Task pages, but near the top of the Task page there will be a table of LINKED ISSUES with links to the Issues that were also created. If you close the Task, the Issue will **automatically be closed!**

Issues on the Place detail page

When an Issue is reported, the Issue shows up on the website at the top of the Place detail page and all Users can see the Issues. The table of Issues allows Moderators to see what is going on with the Place. The table also provides good feedback for the User to inform them that we did indeed receive the Issue and that we are trying to achieve some resolution.

Below is an example of how four reported Issues display on a test Place:



The screenshot displays the iOverlander website interface for a test place. At the top, a map shows the location near Wilderness, Western Cape, South Africa. A red warning banner reads "WARNING: THIS PLACE IS CLOSED!". Below the map, the place details are shown, including the name "test place, delete | Tourist Attraction" and a warning "test place, delete, X". The "Issues" section contains a table with four reported issues:

Reported	By	Type	Description
2016-03-21	Life Re motely	Place is a Duplicate	This place is a duplicate of Timberlake Village (2.1 km East)
2016-03-13	Life Re motely	Place is a Duplicate	This place is a duplicate of Timberlake Village (2.1 km East)
2016-03-21	Life Re motely	Place Closed	I wasn't able to find this place.
2016-03-13	Life Re motely	Place Closed	This is a new test- this place is seriously closed now

The "Latest Check-Ins" section shows several check-ins with the status "Unknown" and a note "This place is in wrong location - it is located at 000000,000000".

Types of Issues

Note: The screenshots below are taken from the website, but nearly the same process appears on mobile devices.

As noted at the beginning of this section, there are five choices for the User when the RAP button is clicked. Let's consider each of the choices:

This Place if closed or doesn't exist

If the User clicks the first option "This place is closed or doesn't exist" the new page will show three more options:

test place. delete.

Is this place closed or no longer in business?

Sometimes places close, ownership changes, or policy changes. If you feel that this place shouldn't be marked as a place that is open for business, please let us know.

Tell us when you visited this place and why you think it is closed.

Date Visited:

☒ This place is permanently closed - it is no longer open for business.

☐ I tried to visit this place but couldn't find it.

☐ Other (leave comment):

Tell us why...

Report Closed Place

- **First option: This place is permanently closed – it is no longer open for business.**

If a User selects this option, the Place is marked 'Closed' and a Check-in is automatically created and the Check-in states "This place is permanently closed". In addition, a Place Correction Task is automatically created so it can be double-checked by a Moderator. An Issue is created just to let us know that a User reported this Issue with the RAP button.

- **Second option: I tried to visit this Place but couldn't find it.**

If a User could not find a Place, the Place is also automatically marked 'Closed'. A Check-in is also automatically created and the Check-in states: "I wasn't able to find this place". A Place Correction Task and an Issue are auto-created.

- **Third option: Other (leave comment):**

If this option is selected, the Place is automatically marked 'Closed'. A Check-in is created automatically which contains the User's comment. A Place Correction Task and an Issue are created.

This Place is in the wrong location.

If the User clicks the option "this place is in the wrong location", there are three additional options. (On the phone, there is a fourth option: the User can report "I'm at this place right now and have correct coordinates on my device."

Below is what is seen on the website when the User selects "This Place is in the Wrong Location":

This place is in the wrong location

Is this place not in the correct location? Please help us fix it here. You can drag the marker in the map to adjust the position, or just enter the new GPS coordinates below.

Location



- **First option: I have the coordinates of the correct location**

If a User knows the new location, the User can enter the coordinates. This action automatically corrects the location and creates a Check-in from the User that says “This place is in the wrong location - it is located at 0.00000, 0.00000”. (Of course, 0.00000 is replaced by the actual coordinates). This option creates a Place Correction Task so Moderators can double-check the correction. NOTE: On phone apps, selecting this option can either pull GPS coordinates from the User’s device, or the User can enter the coordinates manually.

- **Second option: I was unable to find this place.**

If a User is unable to find a place, we ask them to mark the Place as closed. This option simply redirects the User to the previous ‘THIS PLACE IS CLOSED’ screen.

- **Third option: Correct coordinates were not recorded.**

If a User knows the location is wrong, but did not record the coordinates, they can select this option, which creates a Check-in with the User’s comments. A Place Issue Task is also created. A Moderator will review the Place Issue Task and attempt to accurately relocate the Place. Most often, the Moderator will simply copy the User’s comment into the description of the Place to warn future Overlanders. There is rarely enough information (provided by the User) to accurately move the location of the Place, although sometimes Google Maps can assist.

[This Place is a duplicate.](#)

This option allows Users to select a Place that is a duplicate of the Place the User is currently viewing. The page will appear as shown below.

This place is a duplicate

Is this place a duplicate of another place in our database? Please report it here and we'll have someone look into it.

Which place is this a duplicate of?

[Report Duplicate](#)

Selecting this option, creates an Eliminate Duplicate Task that shows the linked issue at the top of the Task page. An Issue is also created, but the Issue will be closed when you close the Task.

[The details, description or amenities are wrong.](#)

The page that shows up when this option is selected will look like this:

test place. delete.

The details, description or amenities are wrong

Are the amenities currently reported for this place wrong? Or is the description missing/inaccurate? Or would you like to add some photos? If so, please check-in to this place and you will have a chance to correct all the amenities.

Check-In to test place. delete.

Again, this option is for Users who can't figure out how Check-ins work! This option simply redirects the User to the Check-in page. No Issues are created. Tasks are created for Place Corrections, as per the usual Check-in process.

Something else... (also referred to as 'Other')

This option is a way for Users to send us comments about a Place AND have the comments attached to their username, with a date and a link to the Place in question. It does NOT create a Check-in: it only creates an Issue. These Issues show up as "Place Issue" Tasks in the Moderator Task list. The User comment must be reviewed, and the Moderator must determine how to resolve the Issue. When the Task is resolved, the Issue is automatically closed.